

Oxford Students Liberal Association

GOVERNING DOCUMENTS

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AARON ZELEKE

Returning Officer, *University College*

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CHANGES FROM THE LAST EDITION

Last Edition: Crossley (03/03/2026)

Motions to amend the Governing Documents

- The *Constitutional Reform (Restructuring and Elections) Motion* was passed at the 3rd Week General Meeting in Trinity Term 2026. This made substantial amendments to the entirety of the Rules and Standing Orders.

Interpretations

- I have amended Emeritus Committee Interpretation 1, with the consent of the Senior President, to reflect that the referenced Rule has moved to a Standing Order.
- I have repealed Returning Officer's Interpretations 1-5, 7,8, 10, 12, and 13, due to them being rendered obsolete by the above mentioned Motion.
- I have amended Returning Officer's Interpretations 6, 9, and 11 for the same reason.
- I have re-numbered Returning Officer's Interpretations 6, 9, and 11 to 1-3.

Minor Corrections

- I have deleted a duplicated phrase in the new Rule 5(4)(b).
- I have corrected the clause numbering in Standing Order 3(3).
- I have deleted a duplicatory offence in Rule 7(5)(b)(xvi) and renumbered accordingly.

Aaron Zeleke,
Returning Officer.

SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION

PREAMBLE

The Oxford University Liberal Club was first founded in 1913, and for over a century has been a key feature of Oxford political life. The Association stands today as an important force in student politics, keeping the flame of Liberalism burning bright in this greatest of universities. These rules serve to enable the noble mission on which we endeavour; to be a space that is welcoming for all, to celebrate free speech and to uphold an unwavering commitment to the cause of liberty.

The burden of our history and our values is great - but one that all Officers and members shall seek to rise to. And they shall succeed, for so long as they place liberty first and foremost in their actions.

STRUCTURE OF THE GOVERNING DOCUMENTS

1.[1] Section 1 is the 'Preamble' and 'Structure of the Governing Documents.' Together these may be known as the 'Introduction'.

2. Section 2 is the 'Standard Constitution' and 'Code of Conduct', which are the adapted version of the documents mandated by the University Proctors. Section 2 shall have ultimate authority with the following clarifications:

> (i) Where the Standard Constitution refers to 'the (Senior) Committee', this is taken to mean only the President, Treasurer, Secretary, and Senior Member. These Officers are henceforth known as the Senior President, Senior Treasurer, Senior Secretary, and Senior Member. All other Position Holders as defined in the Rules and Standing Orders are established in accordance with paragraph 28.
>
> (ii) Where the Association is not registered with the University Proctors, the Standard Constitution, or any references to the Proctors or the Standard Constitution, shall have no force. Should an election for the Senior Committee arise during this period, it shall not take place, and the Senior Committee shall instead be selected by the incumbents, acting with the advice of the Junior President.

3. The Standard Constitution is followed by the Association Rules (Section 3) and Standing Orders (Section 4), as established under paragraph 28 of the Standard Constitution.

4. Section 5 is Interpretations of the Appeals Committee, Emeritus Committee and Returning Officer. Section 6 is any Schedules as may be established from time to time.

5. Taken together, Sections 1-7 shall be known as the 'Governing Documents' of the Association.

[1] Sub-divisions in this Section are by convention known as 'paragraph 1' and so on, as in the Standard Constitution.

SECTION 2: PROCTORS' DOCUMENTS

STANDARD CONSTITUTION

NAME AND OBJECTS

1. The Club is called the Oxford Students Liberal Association (hereafter referred to as "the Club"). The Club's objects are the support, development, improvement and promotion of liberalism, the Liberal Democrats and cross-party political engagement in the University of Oxford insofar as such objects are charitable; and the income and property of the Club shall be applied solely to those objects.

COMPLIANCE

2.

(a) The Club shall be administered in accordance with the University's Regulations for the Activities and Conduct of Student Members.

(b) The activities of the Club will at all times be conducted in accordance with the University's procedures, codes of practice and policies in force from time to time on equality, harassment, freedom of speech and safeguarding (which are available via the University Student Handbook on the University's webpages), and the Club's Code of Conduct.

(c) If there is a national governing body for the Club's activities with which the Club is eligible to register, the Club shall effect and maintain such registration: purchase any insurance cover which the national body makes available (unless the Insurance Section of University Administration and Services agrees to or prescribes other arrangements); and make every effort to comply with all safety procedures which the national body prescribes, or recommends as good practice. If there is no such national governing body, or if the national governing body does not make insurance available, the Club must obtain alternative insurance as agreed by the Insurance Section of University Administration and Services.

(d) The Club shall maintain and observe the Club's Safety Policy, ensure compliance with the Policy by the members of the Club, and follow an appropriate procedure for risk assessment. Both the Safety Policy and the procedure for risk assessment must be acceptable to and approved by the University's Safety Office.

(e) No member of the Club shall participate in any activity overseas organised by the Club, whether during term-time or vacation, unless the plans for such activity have been notified at least one calendar month in advance of the date of departure from the United Kingdom to the University's Safety Office

or the University Marshal and approved by the Proctors. Each member participating in such activities overseas shall observe any conditions imposed by the Proctors on the recommendation of University's Safety Officer or the University Marshal, e.g. relating to the deposit of contact addresses, fulfilment of health, safety and insurance requirements, and stipulation of coaches, trainers or Senior Members to accompany the trip.

(f) The Club shall maintain a dedicated website and shall supply details of its web address to the Clubs Office for listing on the University's clubs and societies webpage. The Club may apply to the University's IT Services to use information technology ('IT') facilities in the name of the Club. Where relevant facilities are allocated by IT Services it is the responsibility of the Club:

(i) to designate a member of the Club entitled to a University e-mail account (as defined by IT Services rules) to act as its IT Officer, whose duties shall include liaising with IT Services about the use of facilities allocated and passing on to the successor in office all records relating to the use of the facilities allocated;
(ii) to designate one of its members (who may be, but need not necessarily be, the same as its IT Officer) or, exceptionally, a member of Congregation, to act as its principal Webmaster, whose duties shall include maintaining an awareness of the University guidelines on web and social media publishing, and co-ordinating and regulating access to the web facilities used by the Club;
(iii) to comply with regulations and guidelines relating to the use of IT facilities published from time to time by IT Services;
(iv) to ensure that everyone responsible under (i)-(iii) is competent to deal with the requirements, where necessary undertaking training under the guidance of IT Services.

MEMBERSHIP

3. The members of the Club shall be those who are eligible and apply for membership of the Club, who are admitted to and maintained in membership by the Committee, and who have paid the relevant Club subscription.

4. Subject to paragraph 5, all student members of the University, and all persons whose names are on the University's Register of Visiting Students, shall be eligible to become members of the Club. A member shall continue to be eligible until given permission to supplicate for a degree, diploma or certificate, regardless of any continuing liability to pay fees to the University.

5. If the Club's objects relate directly to a protected characteristic as defined in section 4 of the Equality Act 2010, the Club may be entitled to restrict membership to members sharing that protected characteristic, provided that the Proctors shall first approve any such restriction.

6. The Committee may also, at its discretion, admit to membership:

(a) students registered to read for diplomas and certificates in the University;
(b) student members of Permanent Private Halls who are not student members of the University;
(c) members of Ruskin College and Ripon College, Cuddesdon;
(d) members of Oxford Brookes University, provided that such members shall not constitute more than one-fifth of the total membership; and
(e) other persons not falling within paragraph 4 above or paragraphs 6(a) to (d) above, provided that such members shall not constitute more than one-fifth of the total membership.

7. The Committee, having specific regard to the Senior Member's advice in relation to the relevant matter, may remove a person from membership if removal of such person from membership is deemed to be in the best interests of the Club. If the person concerned is an Oxford University student (i.e. within paragraphs 6(a), (b) or (c) above), that person has a right to ask the Proctors to review the Committee's decision.

MEETINGS OF THE MEMBERS

8. There shall be an Annual General Meeting for all the members of the Club in Hilary Full Term, convened by the Secretary on not less than fourteen days' notice.

9. The Annual General Meeting will:

(a) receive the annual report of the Committee for the previous year and the annual accounts of the Club for the previous year, the report and accounts having been approved by the Committee;
(b) receive a report from the Committee on the Club's compliance with paragraph 2 above;
(c) receive a report from the Committee on the number of complaints received, if applicable, the category of such complaints (e.g., harassment, funding disputes or service issues), and any Committee recommendations arising from them;
(d) elect Members of the Committee in accordance with paragraph 24 below: the Committee's nominations for the Officers and the Senior Member shall be contained in the notice of the Meeting: any alternative nominations must be seconded and have the consent of the nominee, and must be received in writing by the Secretary not less than seven days before the date of the Meeting: nominations for the other Committee Members may be taken from the floor of the meeting;
(e) consider any motions of which due notice has been given, and any other relevant business.

10. An Extraordinary General Meeting may be called in any Full Term; by the President, the Secretary or the Treasurer on not less than seven days' notice; or on a written requisition by seven or more members, stating the reason for which the meeting is to be called, and delivered to the Secretary not less than fourteen days before the date of the Meeting.

11. Prior to all General Meetings notice of the agenda shall be sent out with the notice of the Meeting.

12. The quorum for a General Meeting shall be ten members present in person or by proxy, of whom three must be members of the Committee. When any financial business is to be transacted there must be present the Treasurer, or a member of the Committee deputed by the Treasurer to represent the Treasurer's views to the Meeting (provided that where it is a case of a deputy, the only financial business transacted shall be that which was set out in the agenda accompanying the notice of the Meeting).

13. Every matter, except where this Constitution provides otherwise, shall be determined by a majority of members present and voting. In the case of equal votes, the President of the Club shall have a casting vote.

14. Minutes of all meetings shall be kept and formally adopted. Copies of the minutes and the Committee's reports shall be made available to members and, upon request, to the Proctors.

THE COMMITTEE

15. The affairs of the Club shall be administered by a Committee consisting of not more than eight persons, which shall determine the subscriptions payable by the members of the Club, and have ultimate responsibility for the activities of the Club. Members of the University shall at all times make up the majority of the members of the Committee. The Committee shall consider the diversity of the Club and the benefits of increased representation for minority groups in its operations, including in the structuring of the Committee. The Committee shall have control of the funds and property of the Club, and of its administration.

16. No member of the Committee (or the Club) shall enter into or purport to enter into any arrangement, contract or transaction on behalf of the Club with a value exceeding £1,000 unless the Committee has resolved to approve the relevant arrangement, contract or transaction at a Committee meeting.

17. The quorum for a Committee meeting shall be four members present in person. When any financial business is to be transacted, there must be present either the Treasurer or a member of the Committee deputed by the Treasurer to represent the Treasurer's views to the meeting.

18. The Committee shall be made up of the President, the Secretary, the Treasurer (together, the "Office Holders"; and their offices are referred to as "the Offices"), the Senior Member and no other persons. The President, the Secretary and the Treasurer shall each be either a member of the Club whose eligibility stems from paragraph 4 above or paragraphs 6(a) to (c) above, or (with the approval of the Proctors) a member of Congregation. Where eligibility stems from paragraphs 6(a) to (c) above, the President, the Secretary and the Treasurer must each, on election to office, sign an undertaking to abide by relevant provisions of the University Student Handbook, as directed by the Proctors from

time to time, and other relevant University policies, and to accept the authority of the Proctors on Club matters.

19. The President shall have the right to preside at all meetings of the members of the Club and at all meetings of the Committee. Should the President be absent, or decline to take the chair, the Committee shall elect another member of the Committee to chair the meeting.

20. Minutes of all meetings, including Committee meetings, shall be kept and formally adopted. Copies of the minutes shall be made available to members and, upon request, to the Proctors.

21. The Secretary shall:

(a) maintain a register of the members of the Club, which shall be available for inspection by the Proctors on request;
(b) give notice of meetings of the members and the Committee;
(c) draw up the agendas for and minutes of those meetings;
(d) notify the Proctors (through the Clubs Office) promptly following the appointment and resignation or removal of Office Holders and other members of the Committee;
(e) take responsibility for the operation and updating of the Club's website displaying (as a minimum) information about the Committee, the Club's Constitution, Code of Conduct, Complaint Procedure and any safety procedures approved by the University's Safety Office under paragraph 2(e);
(f) provide the Insurance Section with full details of any insurance cover purchased from or through a national governing body pursuant to paragraph 2(c) above; and
(g) inform the Proctors through the Clubs Office if the Club ceases to operate, or is to be dissolved, and in doing so present a final statement of accounts (the format of which the Proctors may prescribe).

22. The Treasurer shall:

(a) keep proper records of the Club's financial transactions in accordance with current accepted accounting rules and practices;
(b) develop and implement control procedures to minimise the risk of financial exposure, such procedures to be reviewed regularly with the University's Internal Audit Section ("Internal Audit");
(c) ensure that bills are paid and cash is banked in accordance with the procedures developed under (b);e
(d) prepare an annual budget for the Club and regularly inform the Committee of progress against that budget;
(e) ensure that all statutory returns are made including VAT, income tax and corporation tax if appropriate;
(f) seek advice as necessary on tax matters from the University's Finance Division;

(g) develop and maintain a manual of written procedures for all aspects of the Treasurer's responsibilities;
(h) make all records, procedures and accounts available on request to the Senior Member, the Proctors and Internal Audit;
(i) forward to the Proctors (through the Clubs Office) at the end of week 9 of Trinity Term a copy of annual accounts for the financial year to which they relate (the format of which the Proctors may prescribe) signed by the Senior Member, for retention on the Proctors' files (subject to the condition that during the first year of registration, a club may be required by the Proctors to submit termly accounts); and
(j) if the Club has a turnover in excess of £25,000 in the preceding year, or if owing to a change in the nature or scale of its activities, it may confidently be expected to have such a turnover in the current year, submit its accounts (the format of which the Proctors may prescribe) for independent professional inspection and report by a reporting accountant approved in advance by the Proctors. Accounts are to be ready for inspection within four months of the end of the Club's financial year and the costs of the inspection and report shall be borne by the Club. If requested by the reporting accountant, the Club shall submit accounts and related material as a basis for a review of accounting procedures, the cost likewise to be borne by the Club.

23. The Senior Member shall:

(a) keep abreast of the actions and activities of the Club;
(b) provide information relating to the Club to the Proctors on request;
(c) seek to settle any preliminary disputes between the Committee and the members;
(d) support the Club's welfare officer in their role to seek to prevent incidents of harassment and support those involved in such incidents;
(e) following paragraph 22(i) above, consider whether the accounts of the Club are in order and, if so, sign them;
(f) ensure that adequate advice and assistance is available to the Secretary and the Treasurer in the performance of their responsibilities under paragraphs 21 and 22 above; and
(g) be available to represent and speak for the Club in the public forum, and before the University authorities.

24. The members of the Committee shall be elected by the members of the Club annually, and shall be eligible for re-election. The members of the Club shall not appoint several individuals jointly to hold any of the Offices, nor allow any individual to hold more than one Office at a time. The members of the Club shall appoint a member of Congregation as the Senior Member when electing other members of the Committee each year provided that a Senior Member who has previously held office as Senior Member for more than five consecutive years shall not be eligible for re-appointment. The Senior Member shall be a member of the Committee *ex officio*.

25. If during the period between the annual elections to offices any vacancies occur amongst the members of Committee, the Committee shall have the power of filling the vacancy or vacancies up to the next Annual General Meeting by co-optation.

26. Each Office Holder must, and shall procure that other Office Holders shall, at the end of any term of Office, promptly hand to the relevant successor in Office (or to another member of the Club nominated by the Committee) all official documents and records belonging to the Club, together with (on request from the Committee) any other property of the Club which may be in the outgoing Office Holder's possession; and must complete any requirements to transfer authority relating to control of the Club's bank accounts, building society accounts, or other financial affairs.

27. Without derogating from its primary responsibility, the Committee may delegate its functions to finance and general purposes and other subcommittees which are made up exclusively of members of the Committee.

28. The Committee shall have power to make regulations and by-laws in order to implement the paragraphs of this Constitution, and to settle any disputed points not otherwise provided for in this Constitution.

29. No member of the Committee shall be removed from office except by a majority vote of a disciplinary committee of three members of the Club who are not members of the Committee appointed by the Senior Member for that purpose and acting in consultation with the Senior Member (or the Proctors if the member of the Committee to be removed is the Senior Member or if the Senior Member is otherwise conflicted).

INDEMNITY

30. So far as may be permitted by law, every member of the Committee and every officer of the Club (each a "relevant officer") shall be entitled to be indemnified out of the Club's assets against all costs, charges, losses, expenses and liabilities incurred by the relevant officer in the execution or discharge of duties as a relevant officer or the exercise of powers as a relevant officer, or otherwise properly in relation to or in connection with the relevant officer's duties. This indemnity extends to any liability incurred by a relevant officer in defending any proceedings, civil or criminal, which relate to anything done or omitted or alleged to have been done or omitted by the relevant officer in that capacity and in which judgement is given in the relevant officer's favour (or the proceedings are otherwise disposed of without any finding or admission of any material breach of duty on the relevant officer's part), or in which the relevant officer is acquitted, or in connection with any application under any statute for relief from liability in respect of any such act or omission in which relief is granted to the relevant officer by the Court.

31. So far as may be permitted by law, the Club may purchase and maintain for the benefit of any relevant officer insurance cover against any liability which by virtue of any rule of law may attach to the relevant officer in respect of any negligence, default, breach of duty or breach of trust of which the relevant officer may be guilty in relation to the Club and against all costs, charges, losses and expenses and liabilities incurred by the relevant officer and for which the relevant officer is entitled to be indemnified by the Club by virtue of paragraph 30.

DISSOLUTION

32. The Club may be dissolved at any time by the approving votes of two thirds of those present in person or by proxy at a General Meeting. The Club may also be dissolved (without the need for any resolution of the members) by means of not less than thirty days' notice from the Proctors to the Secretary of the Club if at any time the Club ceases to be registered with the Proctors.

33. In the event of the Club being dissolved, its assets shall not be distributed amongst the members, but shall be paid to or at the direction of the University.

CHANGES TO THE CONSTITUTION

34. In accordance with University regulations, if the Club wishes to remain a registered University Club, the Club must seek approval in writing from the Proctors for any changes to this Constitution that deviate from the University's Standard Non-Sports Club Constitution, as amended from time to time. Such approval will only be granted in exceptional circumstances.

35. Changes to this Constitution must be ratified at a General Meeting with the approval of two-thirds of present, eligible and voting members. As such the University recommends that the Proctors' approval is sought prior to seeking to change the Constitution at a General Meeting.

INTERPRETATION

36. Any question about the interpretation of this Constitution shall be settled by the Proctors.

37. This Constitution shall be binding on all members of the Club. No regulation, by-law or policy of the Club shall be inconsistent with, or shall affect or repeal anything contained in, this Constitution.

CODE OF CONDUCT

1. The Oxford Students Liberal Association ("the Club") does not tolerate any form of harassment or victimisation and expects all of its members, employees, and visitors to treat each other with respect, courtesy and consideration.

2. All members of the Club are expected to read and agree to act in accordance with this Code of Conduct and the University of Oxford's Policy and Procedure on Harassment. Oxford students are also required to act in accordance with the Code of Conduct set out in Statute XI. Membership may be removed or suspended for failing to do so, and opportunities for members to take part in activities within and on behalf of the Club may be restricted.

3. All members of the Club are expected to:

- treat other members with dignity and respect
- discourage any form of harassment by making it clear that such behaviour is unacceptable
- support other members who feel that they have been subject to harassment
- attend any mandatory Club training put in place by the Committee

4. "Harassment" includes in particular the following conduct, however carried out (including online):

- verbal or physical bullying or threats
- sexual harassment including unwanted physical conduct, sexually explicit remarks or sexual assault
- racist behaviour or comments
- homophobic or transphobic behaviour or comments
- victimisation
- religiously motivated abuse

5. The Club should designate one or more Position Holders as 'Welfare Officer(s)' who will act as a source of advice and support for Club members in relation to welfare issues and during harassment complaints.

6. The Club's designated Welfare Officers (whose details can be found on the website), can be contacted for informal advice, including in relation to how you make a formal complaint, at accessandwelfare@oxuniliberals.com. Support and advice is also available from the Clubs Office.

7. The Club Complaints Procedure (Rule 7) provides steps for dealing with internal complaints. Clubs are required to have this in place and to follow these steps when they receive a complaint.

8. University of Oxford students can also seek support from:

- one of the University's harassment advisors;
- college harassment advisors (for members of Oxford colleges);

- their college deans or other officers with pastoral responsibilities, the Common Room welfare or equal opportunities officer or a student peer supporter;
- Oxford SU's Student Advice Service
- Student Welfare and Support Services including:
- the University Counselling Service
- the University's Sexual Harassment and Violence Support Service

9. More information is available on the Oxford Students Harassment Pages, including a flow chart explaining the steps within the University's complaints procedures (e.g., for complaints against staff and students).

SECTION 3: RULES

RULES

PART 1: GOVERNING DOCUMENTS

RULE 1(1): GENERAL PROVISIONS REGARDING THE GOVERNING DOCUMENTS

(a) General

(i) As established under paragraph 28 of the Standard Constitution, the Rules and Standing Orders provide the by-laws for the functioning of the Association with regards to matters not covered by the Standard Constitution, and in order to provide more detail.

(ii) The Governing Documents, including the Rules and Standing Orders, shall be binding on all members at all times, and on non-members when attending events of the Association.

(iii) The Preamble, Structure of the Governing Documents, and Code of Conduct shall have the status of Rules except as otherwise provided. Rules shall at all times take precedence over Standing Orders.

(iv) Council or a General Meeting, by two-thirds majority vote, may establish Standing Orders.

(v) Standing Orders, and any specific provision therein, not related to elections may be waived for a named person or persons during term time (Week 0 and 9 inclusive) by a three-quarters majority of Council for a specified immediate or future event, and not retrospectively. During the vacation, this power may be exercised by the unanimous action of the Senior President and one of the Senior Treasurer, Senior Secretary or Junior President, or by Council.

(vii) Schedules may be appended to the Governing Documents if explicitly empowered by other sections of the Governing Documents.

RULE 1(2): INTERPRETATION

(a) Interpretative guidance

(i) The Governing Documents serve to enable the function of the Association, and are not ends in themselves. They shall be interpreted so as to ensure the smooth functioning of the Association in a just and fair manner. Reasonable discretion shall be applied by those entrusted with exercising the operation of the Governing Documents, especially where there are apparent statutory conflicts, such that the Governing Documents do not become an impediment to good governance.

(b) Interpretative authority

(ii) Bodies with interpretative authority shall be, in order of seniority with the most senior first, the Appeals Committee, the Emeritus Committee, and the Returning Officer.

(iii) All bodies listed in (ii) shall be able to issue Interpretations and Rulings. Rulings shall relate to a specific scenario and shall only be binding in the instant case. Interpretations shall not relate to a specific scenario and shall be binding generally. Rulings shall only be for non-disciplinary matters.

(iv) Interpretations and Rulings shall be deemed issued upon being sent in writing to the Senior President and Junior Officers. Interpretations should be appended to the Governing Documents. In the case of the Returning Officer, this shall be done within 96 hours of a request being received, or 24 hours where the Senior President agrees with the requesting member that the matter is sufficiently urgent.

(v) The Returning Officer may, with the consent of the Senior President, amend or repeal Interpretations of more senior bodies, only where the Rule or Standing Order in question has been amended. Any body may repeal or amend the Interpretation of a body junior or equivalent to themselves.

(vi) Where an individual is an Acting Returning Officer (or Clerk) for a specific purpose, as determined elsewhere in these Governing Documents, they shall have the powers listed in (iii) of the Returning Officer only for those specific purposes for which they are deemed to be the Acting Returning Officer (or Clerk). The Senior President shall reasonably resolve any conflicts over jurisdiction.

(c) Challenges and Appeals

(i) Any member may, within 72 hours of any decision or action being taken by any Position Holder or Body (save the Emeritus or Appeals Committees), file a request for a Ruling with regards to that decision or action to the Returning Officer. Such a Ruling may quash the decision or action on the grounds that it misapplied, misinterpreted or otherwise breached the Governing Documents. Any member whose decision(s) or action(s) are being challenged, or who stands to be severely affected by its outcome, shall have the right to make representations to the Returning Officer.

(ii) Rulings or Interpretations of the Returning Officer or the Emeritus Committee may be appealed in accordance with Rule 7.

(iii) Other parts of the Governing Documents may explicitly set down alternative mechanisms of challenge or appeal that do not comply with (i) above, for example by progressing straight to the Emeritus Committee.

(iv) This clause shall not apply to matters directly relating to the termly election.

RULE 1(3): DEFINITIONS

(a) A '*simple majority'* vote, as referenced in these Rules and Standing Orders, is defined as more people voting for than against, or vice-versa, of those who are present and eligible who choose to vote. Abstentions and spoilt ballots should be counted separately, and don't count as votes for or against.

(b) A '*two-thirds majority'* vote, as referenced in these Rules and Standing Orders, is defined as 66.67% of those who are present and eligible to vote, who choose to vote. Abstentions and spoilt ballots should be counted separately, and don't count as votes for or against.

(c) Where the words '*in writing*' or similar are used in these Rules and Standing Orders, this is taken to mean via letter or email unless explicitly stated otherwise.

(d) '*In statu pupillari*' is defined as being in possession of a valid University of Oxford or Oxford Brookes University student card, and being a current undergraduate or postgraduate student (or in possession of evidence of one's status as a suspended student).

(e) '*Good Reason'* for the purposes of passing absences is defined as illness or disability related issues, academic commitments, serious and pressing personal matters and other reasons as determined by a two thirds majority vote of the body in question.

(f) Where these Governing Documents refer to the '*membership*', including for the purpose of circulation, this shall be taken to mean the membership *in statu pupillari,* unless explicitly provided for otherwise. Members not *in statu pupillari* may request to the Junior Secretary to be included in such circulations and other matters, and from that point forwards Position Holders shall be obliged to include them.

(g) '*Ex-Officer*' shall be taken to mean Ex-Senior Officers, Ex-Junior Officers, Ex-Returning Officers and Ex-Senior Members.

(h) *'Term'* shall be the University of Oxford's terms, including the preceding vacation (i.e. Hilary and the Christmas Vacation). *'Full term'* shall be Sunday of 1st Week to Saturday of 8th Week of each term, inclusive.

(i) Rules and Standing Orders shall be cited as follows: Rule 1 or Standing Order 1(1) > clause (a) > sub-clause (i) > paragraph (A) > sub-paragraph (I).

RULE 1(4): AMENDMENTS TO THE GOVERNING DOCUMENTS

(a) General

(i) Any member may propose a Governing Documents Motion to the Rules or Standing Orders in a General Meeting. Such a motion shall require a two thirds majority to carry.

(ii) Members of Council may propose a Governing Documents Motion to the Standing Orders in Council. Such a motion shall require a two thirds majority to carry.

(iii) Any Governing Documents motion changing the Preamble, Structure of the Governing Documents, and Code of Conduct shall require the consent of a majority of the Senior Committee.

(iv) Any member wishing to change the Rules or Standing Orders at a meeting should send a Governing Documents Motion to the Returning Officer, and the Senior Secretary (in the case of a General Meeting) or the Junior Secretary (in the case of Council), in time for the Agenda submission deadline for that meeting. All Governing Documents Motions shall include on the first page a list of Rules and Standing Orders affected.

(v) All changes shall come into force from the conclusion of the meeting in which the Motion is carried. Motions to amend the Standing Orders may specify within themselves that commencement of the amendment is to be delayed to a date no longer than four weeks after the passage of the Motion.

(vi) Should a General Meeting determine to change, delete, or create a Standing Order, Council may not change, delete, or re-instate such a Standing Order until the beginning of the next term. The General Meeting passing such a change may explicitly dis-apply this prohibition.

(vii) All Governing Documents Motions moved under this Rule shall have a title that states its general purpose.

(b) Validity

(i) The Returning Officer shall be responsible for ensuring all Governing Documents Motions are compliant with the procedure in this Rule and the Governing Documents, and shall be obligated to invalidate any Governing Documents Motion that violates said procedure. The Returning Officer shall also ensure that any Governing Documents Motions are in line with the provisions of the Proctors Documents. Invalidating an Amendment Motion shall be done via a Ruling, which may be appealed.

(ii) The conclusion of the meeting in which an Amendment Motion (purportedly) passes shall be deemed to be the time of the request for a Ruling. Should no Ruling of invalidation be issued before the conclusion of the time period available as under Rule 1, a 'Ruling not to invalidate' shall be deemed

issued for the purpose of any appeal to the Emeritus Committee. The Returning Officer may only invalidate the entirety of a Governing Documents Motion, not specific parts.

(iii) Where necessary, the Returning Officer may, with the consent of the Senior President, suspend the enactment of a Governing Documents Motion if there is a genuine question as to whether it is compliant with the Standard Constitution that they feel they cannot answer themselves. They shall refer the matters to the Proctors for interpretation as swiftly as possible. Such suspension may be lifted by the Returning Officer at any time, with the consent of the Senior President.

(c) Maintenance of the Governing Documents

(i) If a Governing Documents Motion is validly passed, the Returning Officer should make the necessary edits to the Governing Documents as well as adding the Motion to a separate digital and paper folder that is available to the membership, for historical accuracy.

(ii) The Returning Officer is responsible for keeping the Governing Documents and the History of Amendments folder up to date. These documents must be provided to any member within 24 hours of asking.

(iii) The Returning Officer shall also be empowered to make minor edits or correct cross-references for clarity without need for a motion, the procedure for which shall be defined in a Standing Order.

(d) Amendments to Governing Documents Motions

(i) Members may propose to alter the text of a Governing Documents Motion being proposed in a Meeting from that which is circulated with the Agenda. This may be done with the consent of the proposer, and a Senior Officer or the Junior President, or the Returning Officer.

(ii) Use of the alterations provision to significantly or elusively change the Governing Documents without due notice shall be a Disciplinary Offence and shall ordinarily be grounds for invalidity of the amendment.

(iii) The terms of the alteration shall be circulated in writing to the relevant Secretary and the Returning Officer, or stated explicitly for the recording and minutes. If only stated orally, it shall be sent in writing within two hours of the close of the Meeting.

(iv) Documents with live editing provisions may be employed for the purposes of 'circulating in writing' in the sub-clause above, so long as the edit history may be accessed and recorded by the Returning Officer upon request.

(e) Special provisions for Governing Documents Motions in Trinity Term 2026

(i) In Trinity Term 2026 only, the Rules may be amended by a two-thirds majority of Council, should such a Motion be certified as 'corrective' to any Motion to amend the Governing Documents passed in Trinity Term 2026 by a General Meeting. Such certification must be done by two of the Senior President, Senior Treasurer, Senior Secretary, and Returning Officer.

(ii) This clause (e) shall automatically repeal on Sunday of 9th Week, Trinity Term 2026.

PART 2: OBJECTS

RULE 2(1): OBJECTS

(a) The Association shall have these objectives further to those set out in the Standard Constitution:

(i) To stimulate among Members of Oxford the University of Oxford a greater interest in, and understanding of, the Liberal Democrat Party and its principles;

(ii) to extend the influence of Liberal ideology among Members of Oxford the University of Oxford;

(iii) to work towards the benefit of the local community in Oxford, and others in need, by pursuing charitable activity;

(iv) to encourage, promote and facilitate political education, participation and cross-party cooperation among Members of Oxford the University of Oxford.

PART 3: MEMBERSHIP

RULE 3(1): ORDINARY MEMBERSHIP

(a) Ordinary Membership shall be open to those people listed in the Standard Constitution, with a fee to be determined in accordance with the Standing Orders.

(b) Any form that allows eligible individuals to become members shall require them to give their consent to abide by the Governing Documents, in order to become members.

RULE 3(2): HONORARY MEMBERSHIP

(a) The Standing Orders may establish a process by which individuals not eligible under Rule 3(1) may be admitted as Honorary Members.

PART 4: POSITION HOLDERS

RULE 4(1): GENERAL PROVISIONS REGARDING POSITION HOLDERS

(a) Classes of Officer

(i) The 'Junior Officers' shall be the Junior President, Junior President-Elect, Junior Treasurer and Junior Secretary. The 'Portfolio Officers' shall be the Women's Officer, Social Secretary, Director of Communications and Publications Editor. There shall be 'Appointed Officers' as defined by Standing Order.

(ii) Junior or Senior Officers may not hold any other position in the Association, save that the Junior President-Elect may hold an additional Junior Office. Senior Officers may not hold the powers and duties of other positions from time to time.

(iii) The Junior Officers shall ordinarily be referred to without the prefix Junior (e.g. 'the President'), unless clarity demands otherwise.

(iv) Other parts of these Governing Documents may also create Position Holders, or grant members the status of Position Holders for specific purposes.

(b) Terms of Office

(i) The Senior Officers shall serve for one year.

(ii) The Junior Officers save the Junior President-Elect, Portfolio Officers, and Appointed Officers shall serve for one term.

(iii) The Junior President-Elect shall serve one term as Junior President-Elect, and on the conclusion of that term shall succeed to the office of Junior President, which they shall occupy for one term.

(c) Other general provisions

(i) Where the operation of any Rule or Standing Order would result in the removal of office of a Senior Officer, that removal shall not take place. Instead, the Emeritus Committee (in this circumstance made of three members only) must be summoned as swiftly as possible. In accordance with the Standard Constitution, a Senior Officer may only be removed by a body that would constitute an appropriate Disciplinary Committee, though such bodies shall be strongly advised by the function of other Rules and Standing Orders.

(ii) All Position Holders may resign in writing to the Junior President. The Junior President may resign in writing to the Senior President and Junior President-Elect. All Position Holders may announce the date of their resignation up to two weeks in advance, so as to allow time for vacancy procedures to be enacted before they leave office.

RULE 4(2): RESPONSIBILITIES OF POSITION HOLDERS

(a) The Junior President

(i) Co-ordinating the work of non-Senior Committee Position Holders, with the oversight of the Senior President. As part of this duty, they may reasonably apportion duties and responsibilities not otherwise reserved to other Position Holders as needed for the functioning of the Association.

(ii) The logistical and administrative production of the termcard.

(iii) The general organisation and administration of the Association, with the oversight of the Senior President.

(b) The Junior President-Elect

(i) Deputise for the Junior President when requested, and assist the Junior President in the preparation of the term card.

(ii) Actively prepare for their term of office.

(c) The Junior Treasurer

(i) Assist the Senior Treasurer with the management of the Association budget.

(ii) Take payments at events when required.

(d) The Junior Secretary

(i) Where it is not a defined duty of the Senior Secretary, minute meetings.

(e) The Returning Officer

(i) Maintain and publish the authoritative version of the Governing Documents and make formal Interpretations and Rulings where required.

(ii) Run any elections that take place except as otherwise provided, and take overall responsibility for their smooth process and the returning of the results.

(iii) Remain generally independent on matters of internal politics, and not seek to advantage any individual member. They shall also advise members on the content and interpretations of the Governing Documents.

(iv) Where they are informed or gain the knowledge that a Position Holder may be in breach of their duties, or of the Governing Documents of the Association, they should raise this to the Position Holder, if possible. If there is a further instance of no resolution, or no rectification is possible, the Returning Officer shall move a Disciplinary Complaint in accordance with Rule 7.

(v) Should the Returning Officer be conflicted, unable, or otherwise unwilling, they may voluntarily delegate their authority on any given matter to the Vice Returning Officer, with the consent of a Senior Officer.

(vi) The Returning Officer shall brief any new Women's Officer or Welfare Officer as soon as possible on the Association's Complaints process, so as to enable them to fulfil their duties.

(f) The Women's Officer

(i) To be the designated point of contact for women with any concerns about access and barriers to engagement with the Association and its events.

(ii) To advocate for women's access and engagement in the Association.

(iii) To advise women as necessary how to utilise the Association's Complaints process.

(g) The Social Secretary

(i) Organising socials, in particular Liquor and Liberalism.

(ii) Collaborating with the Junior Officers to ensure room bookings.

(h) The Director of Communications

(i) Running the Association social media, advertising events and raising awareness about the Association.

(i) The Publications Editor

(i) Ensuring at least seven articles per term are published, digitally or physically, by members of the Association in either our own publication, or in another Liberal publication, as approved by Council.

RULE 4(3): VACANCIES

(a) General provisions regarding vacancies

(i) The Returning Officer shall be responsible for administering succession procedures. Where the vacancy concerns the Returning Officer, the Junior President shall be responsible.

(ii) Unless otherwise specified, individuals who fill vacancies shall hold their new role until such time as the original term of office would have concluded.

(iii) No member who has resigned or been removed from any Position shall be eligible to be re-appointed, re-elected or otherwise assume that Position, or any more senior Position according to the Table of Seniority, again in that term.

(b) Interim allocation of powers and duties

(i) Until such time as succession procedures under this Rule have concluded and unless otherwise specified, the powers and duties of any vacant position shall fall to the Junior President, who may delegate them to any person they see fit in an 'Acting' capacity.

(ii) The powers and duties of a Senior Officer, in the event a Senior Office is vacant, shall fall to the Returning Officer. The powers and duties of the Junior President or the Senior Member, in the event either position is vacant, shall fall to the Senior President. The powers and duties of the Returning Officer or Vice Returning Officer, in the event that Position is vacant, shall fall to the most senior consenting member according to the Standing Order detailing seniority amongst Electoral Officials.

(iii) Should any vacancy occur in a Junior or Portfolio Office, save Junior President, after the announcement of the results in the termly election, the Returning Officer shall offer the relevant Position Holder Designate the option to succeed to Office early. Should they accept, succession as otherwise specified under this Rule shall not take place and they shall immediately assume the Office and then complete the term they were elected/appointed to. Should they decline, succession under this Rule shall occur.

(c) Senior Committee

(i) Should a position on the Senior Committee become vacant, the Senior Committee shall co-opt an individual to fill that position as soon as possible.

(ii) The co-option of a new Senior Member shall also require the ratification of a two-thirds majority of Council.

(d) Junior Officers

(i) Should the Office of Junior President become vacant, it shall automatically be succeeded by the Junior President-Elect, who shall become the Junior President until such time as the Junior President-Elect's term as Junior President would have concluded. They shall continue to serve as Junior President-Elect simultaneously. Notwithstanding any other provision in these Rules and Standing Orders, there shall always be a Junior President and if absolutely necessary, the Returning Officer shall employ variations of procedures set out in these Rules to fill that office.

(ii) The Junior President-Elect shall only succeed under (i) exactly 24 hours after being notified by the Returning Officer in writing of the vacancy. They may waive this right before the 24 hours conclude. In this event, the Returning Officer shall offer in writing the position of Junior President to members in order of seniority, only of those junior to the Junior President-Elect and excluding the member who vacated the office of Junior President. They shall write to members in batches of 7 every 24 hours until there is an acceptance. The most senior person accepting the offer shall be deemed the Junior President at the conclusion of the 24 hour period after they were written to, and shall thereupon resign any existing Position.

(iii) Should the office of Junior President-Elect become vacant, the Returning Officer shall organise a by-election for that Position, which may be incorporated as part of the termly election with the consent of Council, or may be a separate election held on a convenient date following the ordinary procedures *mutatis mutandis*. None of the Above shall not be an option. If there is only one validly nominated candidate, they shall be deemed elected with no need for a vote.

(iv) A three-quarters majority of Council may waive the requirement in (iii) above and ratify a member nominated by the Junior President to assume the office of Junior President-Elect.

(v) Should the position of Junior Treasurer or Junior Secretary become vacant, the Junior President shall propose a replacement member (who is not the Junior Treasurer or Junior Secretary), who Council may choose to ratify by two-thirds majority.

(e) Portfolio Officers

(i) Should a Portfolio Office become vacant, the Junior President shall propose a replacement member, who Council may choose to ratify by two-thirds majority.

RULE 4(4): MISCELLANEOUS PROVISIONS REGARDING POSITION HOLDERS

(a) The Re-Founding Committee

(i) The members of the Re-Founding Committee of Hilary and Trinity Term 2024 shall hold the relevant seniority as if they were elected to their respective offices.

(b) Unusual Circumstances

(i) In circumstances where the Junior President is simultaneously serving as Junior President-Elect, they shall be empowered to delegate any and all of the powers and duties of the Junior President-Elect to any consenting Position Holder. This may be revoked at any time.

(c) Automatic Resignations

(i) The following shall result in the relevant Position Holder being deemed to have resigned from their Position:

> (A) Failure of members of the Emeritus Committee to report within two weeks, unless granted a legitimate extension, or unless the delay is prospectively agreed by all parties.
>
> (B) Failing to present a written or oral report in accordance with the Rules and Standing Orders, without good reason, to the 6th Week General Meeting, including the Annual General Meeting.
>
> (C) Failure of the Junior Treasurer, without good reason, to present the financial report to the Termly General Meeting or to appoint a delegate to do so on their behalf.
>
> (D) Failure to attend three events at which one's presence has been requested by the Junior President or which the duties of the Position Holder's role would require their attendance, without good reason or without the permission of the Junior President.
>
> (E) Failure of the Publications Editor to release at least three publications by the conclusion of Week 4 of each term.

(ii) Automatic resignations may be specified elsewhere in the Governing Documents.

(iii) Automatic resignations shall take place immediately upon any failure listed in (i) or elsewhere in the Governing Documents occurring, save that:

> (A) Automatic resignations in relation to meetings shall be dated from the close of the final meeting in which 'good reason' could have been voted on, ordinarily the next meeting of Council, unless specified elsewhere.

PART 5: TERMLY ELECTIONS

RULE 5(1): ELECTORAL OFFICIALS

(a) There shall be a team of Electoral Officials, comprising at a minimum the Returning Officer, and the Deputy Returning Officers. One Deputy Returning Officer shall be designated as the Vice Returning Officer. The selection and removal of Electoral Officials shall be governed by Standing Order.

(b) The Returning Officer shall be selected at least once every two terms.

(c) No person who is a voting member of Council shall be an Electoral Official.

RULE 5(2): GENERAL PROVISIONS REGARDING TERMLY ELECTIONS

(a) General

(i) There shall be an election each term for the Junior Officers, excluding the Junior President, and the Portfolio Officers. Elections to Senior Officer shall not be governed by this Rule, save as stated otherwise.

(ii) The Returning Officer shall have control and be responsible for all elements of the termly elections process.

(iii) The Senior Committee shall remain neutral in the termly election. The Senior Treasurer shall oversee the election but shall not override or otherwise diminish the powers of the Returning Officer. The Senior Treasurer shall not sit on any Emeritus Committee business arising directly from a termly election, save with the unanimous consent of all parties.

(iv) There shall be a Standing Order entitled 'Termly Election Regulations', which shall provide for questions not otherwise covered by the Rules. Council may only amend this Standing Order by two thirds majority with the consent of the Returning Officer or the Senior Treasurer, or by a

three-quarters majority. This Standing Order may not be amended from the opening of nominations each term until the first day of the vacation.

(b) Officers Designate

(i) Election winners shall immediately assume the title of Position-Designate (e.g. Junior Secretary-Designate or Junior President-Elect Designate) from the announcement of the results.

(ii) At the beginning of Sunday of 9th Week they shall assume the full Office.

RULE 5(3): ELIGIBILITY AND NOMINATIONS

(a) Eligibility

(i) All candidates must be non-honorary members of the Association.

(ii) The Returning Officer shall determine if members are eligible in accordance with any eligibility requirements set down in the Termly Election Regulations, and shall note any candidates deemed invalid, and the reason(s) why, with the list of validly nominated candidates.

(b) Nominations

(i) The Returning Officer shall create a digital nomination form. This form shall be where members submit evidence of campaigning and party membership, though this may also be done separately by email or in person.

(ii) Nominations shall open by the end of Monday of 5th Week and shall close at 1800hrs on Thursday of 5th Week. The Returning Officer shall publish the full list of validly nominated candidates by the end of Friday of 5th Week.

(iii) Slates must be declared to the Returning Officer on nomination forms, with candidates listing all the other members of their slate. Slates may include a maximum of one candidate for each available position.

(iv) If no candidates validly nominate for a position by the deadline, the Returning Officer may extend nominations for that role by up to 24 hours, and should encourage members to nominate. If there are no further nominations within this period, the elections shall continue as normal without an election for the position with no candidates.

(v) After the election, the Junior President-Elect may appoint a member to fulfil any role that received no nominations in the election, via the procedure for Appointed Officers *mutatis mutandis*, requiring a two-thirds majority for ratification at an 8th Week Meeting of Council.

RULE 5(4): VOTING AND BALLOT PAPERS

(a) Structure of the termly elections

(i) Where, upon the close of nominations, more than one valid nomination is received for any Junior Office, a Poll shall be arranged. Where all Junior Offices are uncontested, disregarding the option of 'None of the Above', the termly elections shall take place in the Termly General Meeting.

(ii) Votes in General Meetings shall be conducted in the Meeting, and any adjournments or other amendments to ordinary meeting procedure that have the effect of creating a Poll or partial Poll shall not be permitted, save with the unanimous recorded consent of the Senior Officers.

(iii) The timing of a Poll shall be set down in the Termly Elections Regulations, save that it shall always be at least 90 minutes long.

(b) Ballot paper

(i) Elections shall be conducted by paper ballot Alternative Vote.

(ii) Each ballot paper shall have each position listed with candidates in alphabetical order by surname. It shall also list their slate and their seniority. Members with more than one claim to seniority may request on their nomination form to have a different seniority than their highest claim listed on the ballot, if they wish.

(iii) All ballot papers shall be given a unique serial number and a record shall be securely stored by the Returning Officer of all members who have voted and their unique ballot number. The ballot paper shall contain instructions to vote with Arabic numerals and to not use red pen.

(iv) 'None of the Above' shall appear last on each ballot paper. If None of the Above wins any position, it shall be treated as if no nominations had been received. No person who stood as a candidate in an election where None of the Above was the winner shall be eligible to be appointed to that position in the term which the election was for.

RULE 5(5): ELECTORAL MALPRACTICE

(a) The following shall be instances of electoral malpractice (and thus disciplinary offences):

(i) Committing any criminal or University offence, or any College offence within the jurisdiction of the relevant College, in connection with the elections.
(ii) Deliberately or through avoidable negligence breaking any Rule of the Association judged to be appertaining to either the conduct or result of elections.
(iii) Influencing or attempting to influence a voter by means of bribery, intimidation or treating.
(iv) Disrupting the conduct of the elections or the count.
(v) Deliberately including any factual error in a candidate's electoral publicity or hustings address.
(vi) Paying for someone else to join the Association.
(vii) Misusing one's position as a Position Holder in the Association to hinder or promote any candidate.
(viii) Stealing, intercepting or defacing any mail or publicity relating to the election.
(ix) In good faith or otherwise, substantially affect the result of the election either via negligence, or misinterpretation or misapplication of the Governing Documents.

(A) No penalty or consequence shall be imposed on any person upon whom a Complaint is upheld under Rule 5(5)(a)(ix). Such Complaints shall as far as possible not be referred to as 'malpractice.'

(x) Attempting, aiding, abetting or conspiring to perform any form of electoral malpractice.
(xi) Committing any other disciplinary offence in direct connection with the elections.
(xii) Lying to the Returning Officer, another Electoral Official, or a Senior Officer, at any point during the election process.
(xiii) Breaching the secrecy of the count or the secrecy of the ballot.

PART 6: COUNCIL AND GENERAL MEETINGS

RULE 6(1): GENERAL PROVISIONS REGARDING MEETINGS

(a) General

(i) The Association shall have a body known as Council, which shall be responsible for all matters of governance not otherwise reserved in these Governing Documents. There shall also be at least two General Meetings a term.

(ii) The governance and function of a meeting shall be at the discretion of the Chair, unless overruled by a simple majority of those present and voting. Decisions of the Chair, or motions to overturn them, may not contravene these Governing Documents. In the absence of the designated Chair, the most senior consenting member present, or a member selected by them, shall Chair.

(iii) No member is ever to exercise two separate votes, regardless of whether they hold multiple positions, in an Acting capacity or otherwise - save for when ties must be broken as outlined elsewhere in these Governing Documents.

(iv) Any motion in a meeting shall require a mover and a seconder who are both members of that body. If no member of that body objects, the motion shall pass *nemine contradicente*. If a member objects, a vote shall be held. The secretary shall record the votes of each member of the body, save if the number of members of that body present exceeds 15.

(v) Non-voting members of a body shall have all the rights of a member of that body, save voting.

(vi) Any meeting that is not a General Meeting may move *in camera* by two-thirds majority vote. Only members of that body, or those permitted to be *in camera* by that body may be present for such discussions. No *in camera* matter shall be discussed with any other person, save the Senior Member or Returning Officer. The Senior Member shall have the right to attend any meeting and be present for *in camera* business. Specific provisions may be made by Standing Order to exclude certain members from *in camera* business, for example due to conflicts of interest.

(vii) Whenever a member requests and with the consent of a two-thirds majority of those physically present and voting, they shall be able to join a meeting via an online method (in so far as is technologically possible). They shall be considered as if they are fully present at the meeting, and afforded all the relevant rights as such. This sub-clause does not apply to voting in elections. Meetings may also be fully online where necessary, for example over the vacation.

(b) Quorum

(i) If a meeting doesn't reach quorum, any business conducted within it is deemed invalid. Unless otherwise defined, quorum shall be three for any meeting.

(ii) Objections to the quorate nature of the meeting must be raised in the meeting, at which point a count will take place. Retrospective challenges to quorum are not allowed.

(iii) The exception to (ii) above being that any business conducted in any meeting with just one member present shall be deemed invalid, with no necessity for a challenge to the quorum.

RULE 6(2): COUNCIL

(a) Composition

(i) The following shall be voting members of Council:

(A) The Senior Officers,
(B) The Junior Officers,
(C) The Portfolio Officers,
(D) Up to three other Voting Members, as follows:

(I) Council may appoint up to three members *in statu pupillari,* ordinarily Ex-Officers of the Association or members with relevant experience, to serve as Voting Members of Council by way of a two-thirds majority vote. Such members shall be considered Position Holders for the purposes of meetings, disciplinary processes, and other matters as may be defined by Standing Order.

(II) Council may by three-quarters majority choose to grant any member appointed under (I) above the seniority of an Ex-President, Ex-Treasurer, or Ex-Secretary in recognition of their service.

(ii) The following shall be non-voting members of Council:

(A) The Returning Officer,
(B) The President of the Oxford Brookes Liberal Association or their delegate,
(C) Ex-Officers *in statu pupillari*, who register in writing to the Junior President and Junior Secretary their desire to serve for that term.

(iii) Unless Council moves *in camera,* all Appointed Officers shall have speaking rights and during 'Any Other Business', all members of the Association shall have speaking rights.

(b) Meetings of Council

(i) Ordinary Meetings of Council should be held weekly during 0th Week and full term. The time, date, and location of the meeting should be decided by the Junior President and members of Council given 48 hours notice, which may be done via instant messaging. The Junior President shall Chair.

(ii) Extraordinary Meetings of Council may take place at the behest of the Junior President or any three members of Council acting together. These shall be called in writing to all members of Council with at least 24 hours notice.

(c) Absences

(i) All voting members of Council, and the Returning Officer, are expected to attend all ordinary meetings of Council, excluding the Senior Officers. Failure to attend twice without a passed absence in one term shall result in automatic resignation from office.

(ii) Council may choose to pass absences (and thus they won't count as failure to attend) in exceptional circumstances via a two-thirds majority vote at the meeting in question or the following meeting.

RULE 6(3): GENERAL MEETINGS

(a) General provisions regarding General Meetings

(i) There shall be General Meetings in 3rd Week and 6th Week. The Senior President shall schedule and chair General Meetings, and shall give at least five days' notice. The Senior Secretary shall receive Agenda items no later than 72 hours prior to the meeting, and shall publish the Agenda at least 48 hours prior to the meeting. The 6th Week General Meeting shall be known as the Termly General Meeting.

(ii) The Hilary Termly General Meeting shall constitute the Annual General Meeting, in accordance with the Standard Constitution. The Senior Secretary shall give 14 days notice of this meeting, shall invite agenda items to be submitted to themselves for up to seven days after the notice of the Meeting is given, and shall publish the Agenda at least 48 hours prior to the meeting.

(iii) At all General Meetings the Junior Treasurer shall present a financial report. At the Termly General Meeting, each Position Holder, save the Senior Committee and Returning Officer, shall be required to present a report on their work during the term so far. Any Junior Officer may request that any Senior Officer or the Returning Officer give a Report via email to them no later than 24 hours after the Meeting is called, and that Senior Officer or the Returning Officer shall then be bound by the reporting provisions for that Meeting.

(iv) The Quorum for a General Meeting shall be ten.

(v) Extraordinary Termly General Meetings may also take place at the behest of a Senior Officer, the Junior President, or seven total members, with six days notice to the Senior President and Senior Secretary. They shall then act in accordance with the timelines in (i) above.

(b) Attendance and absences

(i) Attendance at Termly General Meetings, excluding Extraordinary Termly General Meetings, shall be mandatory for all Position Holders, excluding the Senior Member. Failure to attend without good reason shall result in an automatic resignation. Absences may be passed by a two-thirds majority at the meeting in question or at the next meeting of Council, where all members present shall be allowed to vote.

PART 7: EMERITUS COMMITTEE AND COMPLAINTS PROCEDURE

RULE 7(1): PURPOSE AND COMPOSITION

(a) Purposes of the Emeritus Committee

(i) To form the Association's Disciplinary Committee, and to adjudicate on issues of Electoral Malpractice.

(ii) Exercise interpretive jurisdiction over the Governing Documents, subject to restrictions and procedure.

(iii) Other purposes specified in the Governing Documents.

(b) Composition of the Emeritus Committee

(i) In 8th Week of each term, the Returning Officer shall write to those eligible under (ii) below, including those who will become eligible upon succession at the end of 8th Week, asking them if they wish to be on the Emeritus Committee shortlist, and informing them of the deadline to consent. The deadline shall be at the discretion of the Returning Officer, save that it shall be no later than the end of Saturday of 9th Week. The Senior Officers shall be added automatically with no need to be contacted or to consent.

(ii) The following shall be eligible to be added to the shortlist, so long as they are in *statu pupillari* for the duration of the term; Ex-Senior Officers, Ex-Junior Officers and Ex-Returning Officers. For the avoidance of doubt, this shall include the equivalent Ex-Officers of the Oxford University Liberal Democrats.

(iii) Provisions to add other persons may be set down via Standing Order. No person appointed under this sub-clause shall be eligible to vote in elections of the Emeritus Committee. Any person appointed in this way who is not already a member shall be deemed to be a life member upon approval by the Senior Member of their appointment.

(iv) Members who do not consent to the Returning Officer by the deadline shall be deemed to have opted out. Members may also opt-out at any time during the term. Opting-out under this sub-clause shall result in the removal of all privileges and rights arising from any seniority that entitles a member to sit, save that they shall retain their title.

(v) Members may permanently opt-out of being on the shortlist, and thus the Returning Officer shall not contact them again to be on the Emeritus Committee, but this shall be deemed to be a resignation from all seniority that affords them the right to sit.

(vi) Upon the expiration of the opt-in deadline, the Returning Officer shall present the shortlist to the Senior Member for approval. The Senior Member may strike any member from the shortlist, including Senior Officers. They shall inform the Returning Officer if they have chosen to do so, or not. The Returning Officer shall inform any member if they have been struck by the Senior Member, and then send the final shortlist to Council and the Vice Returning Officer; at this point the new shortlist shall be deemed to be in effect. The Returning Officer shall also read the list at the first available meeting of Council.

(vii) The Junior President, Junior President-Elect, and Returning Officer shall be non-voting members of the Emeritus Committee *ex officio*, and thus entitled to participate in any and all deliberations and proceedings, unless they are a party or serving as Clerk. They may have this right revoked by a two-thirds majority vote of the Emeritus Committee, or the Senior Member, for the purposes of any defined part of the Emeritus Committee's business. Non-voting members may vote in Emeritus Committee elections, and this right may not be revoked.

(viii) In circumstances where any of the current Junior or Portfolio Officers, or the Returning Officer, are eligible to be on the shortlist, they shall only exercise the rights of a voting member with regards to non-disciplinary matters. This shall not prevent them being invited to sit in order to fulfil quorum requirements in accordance with the relevant provision.

(ix) A unanimous decision of the Senior Officers on the shortlist, or a three-quarters majority of Council, may remove a member of the Emeritus Committee for the duration of that term, provided they have the opportunity to present a defence. A three-quarters majority vote of Council, where the Senior Officers may not vote, may overturn a decision of the Senior Officers made under this sub-clause.

RULE 7(2): SUBMISSION OF COMPLAINTS, AND OTHER MATTERS

(a) General

(i) Complaints may be brought where a person believes that a Club member or members have failed to act in accordance with the Club's Code of Conduct, the Governing Documents, the University of Oxford's Policy and Procedure on Harassment, or have acted in breach of their obligations under the Club Constitution, during or in connection with Club activities.

(ii) At all times, the management of Complaints and Appeals shall be conducted in accordance with the principles of natural justice. Nobody who has a conflict of interest should be involved in decision-making under this procedure. If there is a doubt as to whether a conflict exists, advice should be sought from the Senior Member.

(iii) Should the Senior President believe themselves to be conflicted, or be unwilling or unable, to exercise their powers and duties in this Rule, they shall delegate them to a willing and available Senior Officer who is not conflicted. If this is not possible, then another unconflicted individual shall be selected, who shall ordinarily be an Ex-Returning Officer. The Clerk shall exercise the powers and duties until a replacement member is selected. Only the Senior Member may declare the Senior President conflicted if they do not declare themselves to be voluntarily.

(iv) Time limits in this procedure should usually be met by all parties. Time limits may only be extended by the relevant decision-maker(s), with the consent of the Senior Member, where it is necessary to do so in order to ensure a fair outcome (for example, where more time is needed because of a party's illness, the timing of examinations or during the holidays).

(v) The exception to (iv) above shall be that the Clerk may, with the consent of the Senior President, suspend proceedings in a matter for no more than seven days should there be a high likelihood of the Emeritus Committee needing to constitute to hear another matter in the immediate future, and hearing them at once would be more practicable.

(vi) If a Complaint relates to conduct which could constitute a serious criminal offence the Club should seek advice from the Proctors' Office. All time limits are suspended until such advice is received.

(vii) Each Session shall have a Clerk, who shall ordinarily be the Returning Officer. Where the Returning Officer is a party, believes themselves to be conflicted, or is deemed to be conflicted by the Senior President or the Emeritus Committee, a Clerk shall be appointed by the Senior President, who shall ordinarily be the consenting individual most senior according to the Standing Order that lists seniority among Electoral Officials, who is not a party, conflicted, or determining the matter.

(viii) The Clerk shall have the powers and duties of the Returning Officer, but not the office, for the purpose of Rule 7 and that Session only. They shall have no jurisdiction with regards to the rest of the Governing Documents, any conflicts over jurisdiction shall be reasonably resolved by the Senior President.

(ix) The Clerk shall determine the validity of any Complaint or Appeal brought under this Rule, giving strict regards to requirements in this Rule. Any Senior Officer may on request, within 24 hours of invalidity being determined by the Clerk, allow a Complaint or Appeal to proceed to the Emeritus Committee.

(x) The Emeritus Committee shall ordinarily dismiss any Complaint or Appeal, or part thereof, they find to be invalid, which shall result in a verdict of No Case to Answer. Any Complaint, or part thereof, shall be found invalid if the effect would be that a person would be a Subject more than once in respect of the same act of misconduct or alleged act of misconduct.

(xi) Procedures for corporate bodies of the Association, or for specific Position Holders not in a personal capacity, to bring Complaints or Appeals may be laid down via Standing Order, and this and other Rules shall be read, where necessary, so as to facilitate this.

(b) Submitting a Complaint, including Electoral Complaints

(i) All members, or non-members engaged in activities directly connected to the Association, may bring a Complaint against any member, or any non-member engaged in activities directly connected to the Association. Complaints against members, and electoral Complaints against non-members, shall be determined by the Emeritus Committee.

(ii) Non-electoral Complaints against non-members shall be determined by the Returning Officer on the balance of probabilities, following whatever fair procedure they see fit, but giving due regard to precedent and principles in this Rule. Their decisions may be appealed to the Emeritus Committee, on the grounds of appeal listed in Rule 7(i)(i)(A)-(D), where 'Emeritus Committee' shall be read as 'Returning Officer.' The Returning Officer may choose to refer a matter directly to the Emeritus Committee, in which case appeals shall be via the ordinary process.

(iii) The Returning Officer shall maintain an online form, available on the Association website, that allows members to bring Complaints. Complaints may also be filed via email to the Returning Officer, the Vice Returning Officer, or the Senior President. All Complaints must contain the following to be valid:

(A) The name(s) of the Subject(s) or 'Person(s) Unknown' where this is not known,
(B) A description of the behaviour that the person is complaining about.
(C) The offence(s) alleged under the Governing Documents.
(D) A summary of the evidence
(E) The outcome that is sought.

(iv) Evidence not included in the summary in (D) above shall only be admitted with the consent of the Emeritus Committee, should there be compelling reason for its inclusion and reasonable grounds for not including it in the summary.

(v) All non-Electoral Complaints must be filed within three months of the matter being complained about. The Returning Officer or Clerk shall assist with ensuring that complaints are validly submitted, and should a complaint be submitted invalidly within three months of the matter, there shall be a further 7 days available for the Returning Officer or Clerk to aid in ensuring the complaint is re-submitted validly.

(vi) Electoral Complaints must be submitted within 24 hours of the verbal announcement of the results of the election. The Emeritus Committee shall grant the benefit of the doubt of up to one hour.

The additional 7 days outlined in (iii) above shall not apply to Electoral Complaints, and there shall be no obligation on the Returning Officer or Clerk to assist.

(vii) Where absolutely necessary, the Emeritus Committee may suspend succession to any Position affected by a Complaint until the conclusion of their proceedings.

(c) Other Matters

(i) Appeals in accordance with Rule 1(c):

> (A) Any Ruling or Interpretation of the Returning Officer may be appealed to the Emeritus Committee on the grounds that it is unnecessary, incorrect, unreasonable or made in bad faith, incomplete so as to harm the Association or members, or otherwise breached the Governing Documents. The Returning Officer shall be the Respondent to this Appeal. An Appeal must be sent via email to one of the Vice Returning Officer or Senior President, and copied to the Returning Officer, within 72 hours of the issuing of the Ruling or Interpretation.
>
> (B) The Emeritus Committee may choose to temporarily pause or reverse the determinations of the Returning Officer until the conclusion of their proceedings, if they feel that the harm caused by not so doing would be irreversible and detrimental to a party or the Association.

(ii) Election of the Returning Officer:

> (A) The Election of the Returning Officer shall be governed via Standing Order. A Session may, but does not have to be, summoned (with timelines set down by the Standing Order) for that purpose, and any and all timelines and procedures may be varied for that Session by that Standing Order.

(iii) The Emeritus Committee may be summoned for other matters as strictly defined elsewhere in the Governing Documents.

RULE 7(3): SUMMONING, PROCEEDINGS, AND DECISIONS

(a) Summoning the Emeritus Committee

(i) The Clerk shall determine the time at which need has arisen to summon the Emeritus Committee. Once need has arisen to summon the Emeritus Committee, the Clerk shall summon via email all (including non-voting) members of the Emeritus Committee shortlist within 24 hours, providing a summary of the matter(s) to be determined. They shall also inform the Subject or Respondent of the fact of the Complaint or Appeal against them.

(ii) All members of the shortlist consenting within 24 hours of the summoning shall be deemed to be part of a Session. A Session may hear more than one matter at once. The Emeritus Committee shall only be quorate when at least three voting members have consented to be part of the Session. Additional voting members who consent after the deadline may be added later at the discretion of the Senior President. The Clerk shall note the time at which the Session is deemed constituted, which shall be the latest of the 24 hours summons period expiring or the Emeritus Committee being quorate.

(iii) Should three voting members of the shortlist not consent, the Senior President shall invite in order the members listed below (in order of seniority, except for 'consenting members of good character') to sit on the Emeritus Committee, provided that they be *in statu pupillari*, and that the Senior Member consents to their appointment:

(A) Deputy Returning Officers,
(B) Junior Officers,
(C) Any consenting member of good character.

(iv) Senior Officers shall have the status of non-voting members where another Senior Officer is a party to a Complaint.

(v) The Emeritus Committee shall ordinarily be chaired by the Senior President. The Chair shall break all ties unless otherwise specified by the Governing Documents.

(vi) Where the Clerk believes it to be necessary, and with the consent of one of the Senior President or the Senior Member, a matter may be heard before one member of the Emeritus Committee, subject to restriction elsewhere in the Governing Documents. They shall be known as the Delegate of the Emeritus Committee and shall exercise any and all of the functions of the Emeritus Committee and its Chair. The procedure for selecting the Delegate shall be governed by Standing Order. The procedure in the Rules for summoning the Emeritus Committee may be varied as necessary when a matter is to be heard before the Delegate. This sub-clause shall not apply to elections of the Emeritus Committee.

<u>(b) Proceedings</u>

(i) Parties shall have reasonable opportunity to object to the composition of the Emeritus Committee. A member of the Emeritus Committee who is objected to may choose to recuse themselves, or may be recused by a two-thirds majority vote of the other members of that Session. Members may recuse or be recused only for certain matters within one Session, or for all business.

(ii) The Clerk and Emeritus Committee shall arrange meetings and hearings as necessary, with as much notice as possible. A matter may be heard 'on the papers', not requiring a hearing, with the consent of all parties to the matter and the Emeritus Committee.

(iii) All parties may appoint a Representative (or where reasonable, Representatives) for proceedings. This shall not preclude the Emeritus Committee from demanding the presence of a party at a hearing.

(iv) The Emeritus Committee may compel the attendance of a witness at a hearing who is a Position Holder or otherwise holds a title under these Rules. For the avoidance of doubt, 'Ordinary Member' is not a title. Any consenting witness, or member who the Emeritus Committee determines shall be a witness, may be required to produce a written statement in advance.

(v) Subject to the Governing Documents, the Emeritus Committee may adopt any fair way of proceeding it sees fit, including the issuing of binding procedural Directions.

(vi) The Emeritus Committee may adopt an investigative approach where it sees fit, and shall be empowered to bring and decide further Complaints against members if they arise during the course of their proceedings, and only with regards to the matters already before the Emeritus Committee.

(vii) Upon reaching their decisions, the Emeritus Committee shall produce a Report. Upon reporting, a Session shall be deemed concluded. No Session shall be open for more than two calendar weeks. All Reports shall contain the following, where applicable:

(A) The reasoning behind upholding or dismissing the Complaint(s) or Appeal(s),
(B) Any penalties or remedies applied,
(C) Any Interpretations issued,
(D) The details of parties' rights to Appeal, and any relevant deadlines.

(viii) All timelines in this clause and clause (f) including reporting deadlines, save (f)(i)-(ii), shall be halved for Electoral Complaints. Therefore, a Report must be returned within seven days of the deadline for the submission of Electoral Complaints for that election.

(ix) All proceedings shall be audio recorded and minuted, and this shall be the responsibility of the Clerk.

(c) Decisions

(i) Complaints and Appeals shall be upheld on the balance of probabilities, by a simple majority vote of the Emeritus Committee. The Emeritus Committee shall also be empowered to find that there is No Case to Answer.

(ii) Where a Complaint is upheld, the Emeritus Committee may impose any of the following penalties:

(A) Immediate dismissal from any current Position,
(B) Revocation of any degrees of the member's seniority,

(C) Prevention from exercising the powers and privileges of a specific Ex-Position Holder,
(D) Calling an Extraordinary General Meeting to host a Motion of No Confidence in any elected Position Holder, where the threshold for removal will only be 50% + 1 of those present and voting.
(E) A permanent or time-limited ban from standing for any Position, including Senior Committee.
(F) Revocation of some, but not all, of the rights of membership,
(G) Suspension for up to two terms and the preceding vacations;

(I) Suspension shall include the denial of all rights and privileges of membership, save the right to file disciplinary complaints as a member. Suspended members may only attend events in extraordinary circumstances, with the explicit permission of the Junior President and Junior President-Elect. Suspended members shall retain their rights to Appeal.

(H) Expulsion;

(I) Expulsion shall include the denial of all rights and privileges of membership. No expelled member may attend an event of the Association. Expelled members shall retain their rights to Appeal.

(iii) The Emeritus Committee may quash an Interpretation or Ruling and may choose to substitute their own. They may also issue their own Interpretations where believed to be necessary.

(iv) Where an Electoral Complaint is upheld, the Emeritus Committee shall have the power to:

(A) Annul the result of the election either partially or in totality. They shall therefore order a re-poll, which may be subject to fair restrictions at their determination.

(B) Disqualify candidates who have committed electoral malpractice.

RULE 7(4): APPEALS

(a) Grounds of Appeal

(i) Parties to any Session of the Emeritus Committee may Appeal any decision on any or all of the following grounds:

(A) There has been a breach of procedure, such that the process has been rendered meaningfully unfair.

(B) Time limits have not been met, so as to meaningfully deprive a party of their rights.

(C) The Emeritus Committee erred on their interpretation of the Governing Documents, which meaningfully affected the outcome of the case.

(D) The Emeritus Committee demonstrated actual bias in their proceedings or findings such that their proceedings or findings were meaningfully unfair.

(ii) 'Meaningfully' in the above sub-clause shall be understood as where the outcome is of seriousness or importance or that any failure may have caused substantial harm not reparable by means other than Appeal. The goal of permitting Appeals under this clause is not to ensure that the Emeritus Committee was exactly correct on each point of determination, or to correct minor grievances, but to uphold the fair, just and trustworthy nature of proceedings, and to correct major failings.

(b) Submission of Appeals

(i) Any Appeal must be submitted as a single document (attached to an email) within 48 hours of the Report being sent to parties. Where the Emeritus Committee does not meet its required timelines, an Appeal may be submitted at any time from the timeline breach until 48 hours after they report. Appeals should be submitted in writing to the Returning Officer or the Senior President. No Appeal may be more than 2500 words. Appeals shall include a suggested remedy or remedies.

(ii) Appeals under this clause may only be heard where jurisdiction for Appeal is not in the hands of the University Proctors. The Senior Member and Appeals Committee shall take care to ensure that they do not exercise a function which is the prerogative of the University Proctors.

(iii) Should the Senior Member be unavailable or unwilling, they may delegate any and all of their functions under this clause to another unconflicted individual, who need not be a member. The Clerk shall advise the Senior Member of their powers and duties with regards to Appeals.

(iv) The Senior Member shall conduct a *prime facie* review of any Appeal. They shall only consider material presented in the Appeal document, save if they request further evidence. Should the Senior Member determine that there is a reasonable possibility that the Appeal may satisfy any of the criteria in (i) above, they shall grant Leave to Appeal. Should the Senior Member reject the Appeal at this stage, they shall give their reasons in writing and there shall be no further Appeal. This determination must be made within seven days of the filing of the Appeal; if it is not, the Appeal is allowed automatically.

(c) Appeals Committee

(i) Should Leave to Appeal be granted, the Senior Member shall then appoint an Appeals Committee. The Appeals Committee shall be made up of any three unconflicted individuals (who need not necessarily be members), which shall ordinarily include the Senior Member. No person who served on the Emeritus Committee for the same case shall be eligible to serve on the Appeals Committee. The Appeals Committee shall make all decisions by simple majority.

(ii) The Senior Member is encouraged, but not obligated, to appoint themselves, one recent graduate and one current student. The Clerk shall assist the Senior Member in finding members of the Appeals Committee.

(iii) The Returning Officer shall serve as Clerk to the Appeals Committee, unless they are conflicted or unable. Should this be the case, the Senior Member shall appoint a Clerk, who shall ordinarily be someone who appears on the Standing Order detailing seniority among Electoral Officials.

(iv) The Clerk shall inform other parties to the case of the Appeal. They shall be added as Respondent(s) unless they state in writing they do not wish to be. The Appeals Committee shall decide on a fair way of proceeding. This may take any form, including an oral or 'on the papers' hearing, provided that all parties are given a fair and reasonable chance to present their case.

(d) Interim Orders

(i) Should Leave to Appeal be granted, the Senior Member may choose to temporarily pause or reverse the determinations of the Emeritus Committee until the conclusion of the Appeals process, if they feel that the harm caused by not so doing would be irreversible and detrimental to a party or the Association.

(e) Report

(i) The Appeals Committee will then return a Report. They shall make an explicit finding of 'Upheld' or 'Not Upheld' for each ground of Appeal. They shall be explicit in overturning any decision of the Emeritus Committee, if they choose to do so. Should they overturn a decision, they shall replace it with one of their own. Unless otherwise specified, the Appeals Committee may exercise any of the powers of the Emeritus Committee enumerated in the Rules and Standing Orders. The Appeals Committee shall ensure that there is no ambiguity about their findings or the consequences thereof.

(ii) The Appeals Committee shall conclude and report within 10 calendar days of the decision of the Senior Member to allow the Appeal, and shall then be deemed to have dissolved. The Senior Member may extend this for up to a further 10 days, with the consent of another Senior Officer.

(f) Other provisions

(i) The Senior Member may, at the request of a Senior Officer, suspend proceedings in a matter for no more than ten days should there be a high likelihood of the Appeals Committee needing to constitute to hear another matter in the immediate future, and hearing them at once would be more practicable.

RULE 7(5): DISCIPLINARY OFFENCES

(a) General provisions regarding offences

(i) The list below shall be disciplinary offences, at any meeting or event of the Association, or purposes connected to the Association. Disciplinary offences may be listed elsewhere in the Governing Documents, so long as it is clear that they are to be treated as such.

(b) List of offences

(i) Filing a baseless, frivolous, or vexatious Complaint, Appeal, or request for a Ruling or Interpretation. Baseless, frivolous or vexatious Appeals to the Appeals Committee shall be treated as extremely severe.
(ii) Conspiring, or attempting, to commit any offences under this Rule.
(iii) Dereliction of a duty or duties defined in the Governing Documents.
(iv) Violation of the Code of Conduct or University Harassment policy.
(v) Improper conduct or actions that could damage the reputation of the Association or hinder its stated objectives.
(vi) Abuse their Position in the Association for personal gain, or the gain of others.
(vii) Any behaviour that is verbally or physically abusive towards a Position Holder while they are executing their duties or enforcing the Association's Governing Documents, or to any member in connection with the Association. This includes threats, intimidation, and other forms of abuse.
(viii) Violating the University's Integrated Equality and Diversity Policy or any other University policies concerning racial, ethnic, religious, or sexual equality applicable to University societies, staff, or students. This applies to all members, regardless of their affiliation with the University.
(ix) Removing a signatory on the bank account without appropriate process under the relevant Rules and/or Standing Orders.
(x) Breaching *in camera* provisions.
(xi) Purporting to hold seniority, or powers, that the member does not hold.
(xii) Failing to uphold the determinations of a body with interpretive seniority.
(xiii) Knowingly misleading the membership, or any meeting, or other body, of the Association.
(xiv) Acting *ultra vires* to one's powers and privileges as set out in these Governing Documents.
(xv) Conspiring to commit, or attempting to commit, any offence.
(xvi) Acting unreasonably before the Emeritus Committee or Appeals Committee, including failure to comply with procedural Directions.
(xvii) As a (purported) Position Holder, communicate with the media regarding business of the Association without the prior consent of the Senior or Junior President.
(xviii) For any person who is not a Senior Officer, the Junior President, the Junior President-Elect, the Returning Officer, the Clerk to any proceedings under this Rule, or an Ex-President, to contact the Senior Member with regards to the Association without prior consent of the Senior or Junior President, except where an urgent welfare matter so requires.

(xix) Deliberately, or through avoidable serious negligence, breaching the Governing Documents in a way that could reasonably have been foreseen to have impacted any member(s).

RULE 7(6): MISCELLANEOUS DISCIPLINARY PROVISIONS

(a) Returning Officer and Clerk

(i) The Returning Officer shall maintain a guide to Complaints, that shall be available on the website. This shall be a clear and non-technical guide on how to bring a Complaint and how Complaints are managed, and any other information the Returning Officer deems appropriate.

(ii) The Returning Officer shall keep records of the Emeritus Committee, including minutes and recordings of all meetings and hearings, and Reports. Non-anonymised records should be held securely and destroyed when they are no longer needed, in accordance with data protection legislation.

(iii) With the assistance of the Returning Officer, the Committee will keep a record of all Complaints received and prepare an annual report that, in anonymised form, will set out:

(A) the category of such Complaints (e.g. harassment, funding disputes or service issues);
(B) an overview of how Complaints were resolved; and
(C) any Committee recommendations arising from them (for example, what further steps, including training, the Club may wish to consider to deal with incidents of harassment).

(iv) The Clerk for the purposes of determining validity, or the Emeritus Committee at any time, may request further information, including prospective evidence, from all parties.

(b) Particular rights and specific provisions

(i) An Oxford University student (including students in the categories set out in paragraphs 4, 6(a) to (c) of the Standard Constitution) whose membership of the Club is removed under this procedure has a right to ask the Proctors to review the Committee's decision, under paragraph 7 of the Constitution. The Proctors' review will consider whether the appropriate procedure has been followed and whether there has been any procedural irregularity or error. Such a review request should be made within 10 working days of notification of the decision.

(ii) The Senior President and Senior Member may by unanimous agreement, suspend the Subject's Club membership and/or access to Club activities and/or facilities for up to 28 days pending proceedings under this procedure. This shall ordinarily be to prevent the risk of harm or distress to Club members, and this power shall be exercised with significant restraint. Notwithstanding any other Rule or Standing Order, this shall not preclude the individual from standing for election *in absentia*.

(iii) The Emeritus Committee shall ordinarily admit any member who stands to be substantially affected by the outcome of its proceedings (for example, candidates in an election, or a member whose automatic resignation is being appealed) as Interested Parties or Respondents as appropriate. They shall ordinarily be allowed to make representations on equivalent terms to other parties. The Emeritus Committee may choose to hear from Interveners at their discretion, such as members expert in the Governing Documents or with relevant experience.

PART 8: OTHER

RULE 8(1): HONORARY OFFICERS

(a) Honorary Officers

(i) There shall be a Schedule of Honorary Officers ('the Schedule'), which shall be the authoritative record of Honorary Officers of the Association.

(ii) The Schedule may only be amended by the Senior President with the consent of a two-thirds majority of Council.

(iii) The Schedule must state the term of office of any Honorary Officer, which shall not be longer than five years without re-approval. The Returning Officer shall amend the Schedule when any term expires.

(iv) There shall be no more than ten Honorary Officers at any one time.

SECTION 4: STANDING ORDERS

STANDING ORDERS

PART 1: FINANCES

STANDING ORDER 1(1): ACCOUNTS AND DEBIT CARDS

(a) Overall account management

(i) The Senior Treasurer, assisted by the Junior Treasurer, shall be responsible for maintaining an overall budget spreadsheet, and keeping a record of all Association spending. The Junior Treasurer shall be obligated to present the budget and spending to Council if so requested by any member with at least 24 hours notice.

(ii) The Junior Treasurer, in consultation with the Senior Treasurer, shall be responsible for maintaining the Association's cash box, and a record of how much cash the Association is in possession of.

(iii) Only the signatories to the bank account, other Senior Officers, the Junior President-Elect, and the Returning Officer shall be entitled to know the total amount in the Association's bank account.

(iv) Financial business shall ordinarily be conducted *in camera*.

(b) Signatories

(i) The Association bank account is with Metro Bank. Changing this account shall require the alteration of this Standing Order.

(ii) The signatories to the bank account shall ordinarily be the incoming Junior President and Junior Treasurer, and a third member decided by Council. A motion to this effect shall be passed at the meeting of Council immediately following the election, and shall be moved by the Junior President, Returning Officer, or Senior Treasurer.

(iii) Removal of an individual as a signatory, except in accordance with (b) below shall require the approval of a majority of the Senior Officers. Removing an individual without such approval shall be a Disciplinary Offence.

(c) Handover and Debit Cards

(i) At the end of each term, it shall be the responsibility of the outgoing Junior Treasurer to ensure that the new signatories are added to the bank account, and that outgoing signatories are removed. The Junior Treasurer should also hand the cash box to the Junior Treasurer-Designate after the final event of term. The Junior Treasurer shall be required to submit evidence of compliance with this sub-clause to the Returning Officer.

(ii) During the handover period, the Junior Treasurer-Designate shall be subject to the wishes of the sitting Junior President and Junior Treasurer, and shall be compelled when asked to execute transactions on behalf of the sitting Officers, unless said transactions violate other parts of these Rules.

(iii) At all times, only the Senior President, Senior Treasurer, Junior President, Junior President-Elect, Junior Treasurer and Junior Treasurer-Designate shall be allowed to hold an Association Debit Card, unless otherwise authorised by a simple majority vote of Council.

(iv) Upon vacation of any of those Offices, except for when the individual is succeeding to another one of those offices and has permission to keep their card, they shall destroy their Association Debit Card and present evidence of having done so to the Returning Officer. They may only continue to hold said Debit Card if approved by Council for no more than two weeks, subject to renewal a maximum of twice.

(v) If the Returning Officer does not receive timely evidence that a Debit Card has been destroyed or that the signatories and possession of the cash box have been changed, they should act in accordance with Rule 4(2)(e)(iv).

STANDING ORDER 1(2): DEBTS AND CHARGES

(a) Debts to the Association

(i) The Junior Treasurer, with the supervision of the Senior Treasurer, shall be responsible for the administration of debts owed to the Association.

(ii) All debts must be paid back within 28 days of either of the following:

> (A) The member owing monies was informed of their need to pay the Association by any Position Holder, such that, in the Junior Treasurer's reasonable opinion the member knew, or reasonably should have known, about their requirement to pay.
>
> (B) The Junior Treasurer writes to the member to explain the requirement to pay, either after or instead of the member being informed under (A) above.

(iii) Any member with debts still outstanding after 28 days shall be suspended from membership on the terms in Rule 7(3)(c)(ii)(G)(I). They may only attend any event of the Association with the permission of the Senior Treasurer sent in writing to the Junior President and Returning Officer. Should they be a Position Holder, this will be deemed to be a resignation from that Position.

(iv) The Junior Treasurer shall write to the member in question 24-26 days after the member being informed under (ii) above, to inform them of their impending suspension. They shall also inform them of their right to apply for this suspension to be waived, as below. The member may write to the Junior Treasurer to ask for such a waiver at any time before their membership is suspended. Should they apply for this, their suspension shall not take effect until such a time as a decision is made on the waiver.

(v) Upon application, suspensions may be waived in writing by the Junior Treasurer where they believe that the members' financial circumstances so require. This shall only be for 28 days, such that all debts must be repaid within 56 days of the member being informed under (ii) above to prevent suspension.

(vi) Should a debt not be repaid within 14 days of a member being suspended, that member shall be expelled from the Association. They shall be warned by the Junior Treasurer 7 days prior to expulsion. They shall be informed of their expulsion in writing by the Junior Treasurer, who shall also inform the Senior Secretary and Returning Officer.

(vii) Once expelled under this Standing Order, no person may be re-admitted to membership until at least six months have passed, they have re-paid their debt, and a simple majority of Council have approved their re-joining.

(viii) The management of debts owed by non-members shall be at the exclusive reasonable discretion of the Junior Treasurer, though they should be informed by the contents of the procedure for members.

<u>(b) Charges</u>

(i) The Senior Treasurer, Junior Treasurer, or Council, may issue charges for the following reasons:

> (A) An action of a member or non-member has directly caused financial harm to the Association.

(ii) Charges shall be issued via email, and copied to the Returning Officer. In this email the Position Holder shall give reasons for the issuing of the charge, inform a member of their rights under (c) below, the consequences of not paying, and explain to them how to pay - ordinarily via bank transfer.

(iii) Timelines in this Standing Order shall be suspended upon the individual filing an Appeal. All charges shall be paid within seven days of their issuing, else the member shall be deemed to be expelled.

(iv) Charges shall only be issued for the purpose of making the Association financially whole, but this shall not prejudice the right of the Association or Position Holders to pursue action in the courts and by other means where necessary, especially where a charge is not paid.

(c) Applications for relief to the Senior Treasurer

(i) Members may apply to the Senior Treasurer for relief with regards to debts or charges at any point before being expelled under this Standing Order. The Senior Treasurer may agree to establish a payment plan or other such allowances. Where a debt or charge is £50 or less, the Senior Treasurer (having consulted the other Senior Officers) may in exceptional circumstances agree to waive it entirely.

> (A) No payment plan shall last for longer than three months. The Senior Treasurer may enforce a payment plan by suspending or expelling any person who is non-compliant with their plan.

(ii) A member may within three days file an Appeal directly to the Emeritus Committee to overturn or vary a decision of the Senior Treasurer under this Standing Order, which they may do at their absolute discretion. Members may also directly appeal any suspension or expulsion, or lack thereof, on the grounds that procedure was breached.

(iii) Where the Junior or Senior Treasurer is the member owing a debt or (potential) charge, they shall be replaced in this Standing Order by the Junior or Senior President as applicable.

STANDING ORDER 1(3): BUDGETS

(i) Should any event or business of the Association require spending , the Junior Treasurer shall present a budget to a meeting of Council. Council shall, by simple majority, pass or reject the budget. Amendments to the budget may be made in the meeting.

(ii) Any budget exceeding £250, or any recurring expenditure (such as subscriptions), shall require a two-thirds majority of Council to pass, or a simple majority with the approval of the Senior Treasurer.

(iii) The improper spending of Association finances without budgetary approval shall be a disciplinary offence, and should the Returning Officer gain knowledge of any instance of this, they shall be compelled to act in accordance with Rule 4(2)(e)(iv).

(iv) The Junior President or Junior Treasurer may consent to reasonable deviations from a passed budget where unforeseen circumstances demand, usually in extraordinary and urgent circumstances. The Junior President or Junior Treasurer shall move a motion at the next available meeting of Council to approve this deviation. Should this motion fall or not be moved, the Returning Officer shall be

compelled to act in accordance with Rule 4(2)(e)(iv) for an offence under (iii) above and other offences as appropriate.

(v) The Junior President and Junior Treasurer shall be able to authorise spending of £50 or less without need for a motion of Council. They shall give notice of any such spending to the next available meeting of Council.

STANDING ORDER 1(4): PARTY MEMBERSHIP REIMBURSEMENT

(i) The Junior Treasurer shall be required to create a system of reimbursement for the first year of membership for members who also wish to become members of the Liberal Democrats, this system shall ensure that these individuals have joined at the lowest cost rate available to them at the time.

(ii) This right shall be advertised on the website, on the Association's communications platforms at least once termly and where possible in email newsletters.

(iii) In Michaelmas Term, this right shall also be advertised on the Freshers Fair stall, at the discretion of the Junior President.

STANDING ORDER 1(5): CONTRACTS

(i) Only the Junior President, or a member authorised by Council, may sign a contract on behalf of the Association.

(ii) Any contract with implications exceeding £100 shall require the consent of Council.

PART 2: POSITION HOLDERS

STANDING ORDER 2(1): TABLE OF SENIORITY

(a) Table of Seniority

(i) The Senior President,

(ii) [The Senior Member],

(iii) The Senior Treasurer,

(iv) The Senior Secretary,

(v) The Junior President,

(vi) [Honorary Officers],

(vii) The Junior President-Elect,

(viii) The Junior Treasurer,

(ix) The Junior Secretary,

(x) [The Returning Officer],

(xi) Ex-Presidents *in statu pupillari*,

(xii) Ex-Treasurers *in statu pupillari*,

(xiii) Ex-Secretaries *in statu pupillari,*

(xiv) Ex-Returning Officers *in statu pupillari*,

(xv) The Women's Officer,

(xvi) The Social Secretary,

(xvii) The Director of Communications,

(xviii) The Publications Editor,

(xix) The Vice Returning Officer,

(xx) Appointed Officers, *in order of ratification,*

(xxi) [Other Deputy Returning Officers],

(xxii) [Other Ex-Officers], *in order as above,*

(xxiii) Ex-Portfolio Officers *in statu pupillari, in order as above,*

(xxiv) Ex-Appointed Officers *in statu pupillari*, *in order as above,*

(xxv) Ex-Deputy Returning Officers *in statu pupillari,*

(xxvi) [Other Ex-Position Holders], *in order as above,*

(xxvii) Ordinary Members *in statu pupillari*,

(xxviii) Other Ordinary Members,

(xxix) [Honorary Members].

(b) Details and exemptions

(i) Members must hold a Position for at least 28 days in order to hold the relevant seniority, except in cases where they leave the office for serious illness or death. Should their term be shorter than 28 days by virtue of them filling a vacancy, then they shall only be required to finish their term and not be in office for 28 days in order to hold seniority.

(ii) A member who has more than one claim with regards the above table, shall be considered to have multiple seniorities. Seniorities shall take precedence in order of the table where necessary. Honorary Officers *in statu pupillari* shall not hold seniority as an Honorary Officer until they cease to be *in statu pupillari.*

(iii) In circumstances where more than one person holds a certain title (i.e. where there are a number of ex holders of a position), the person who was elected/appointed most recently shall be considered the

most senior and so on, with the person elected/appointed the longest ago considered the least senior.

(iv) Positions listed in closed brackets [ ] shall not have seniority for the purposes of elections or succession, only for matters such as agenda order and chairing meetings.

(v) Being an Ex-Holder of an 'Acting' Position shall not entitle a member to seniority.

(c) Equivalent past Positions

(i) Ex-Spirits Officers shall be deemed to be Ex-Social Secretaries.

(ii) Ex-Chairs of College Branch Societies shall be deemed to be Other Ex-Appointed Position Holders.

(iii) Ex-Vice Presidents shall be deemed to be Ex-Secretaries.

(iv) All other Ex-Positions shall be deemed to be Other Ex-Appointed Position Holders, unless the Returning Officer and Senior President agree that a different Ex-Position is more appropriate.

STANDING ORDER 2(2): APPOINTED OFFICERS

(i) The Junior President-Elect shall, at a meeting of Council in 8th Week, propose to appoint no more than eight members via the instrument of Order(s)-in-Council. Such Order(s) shall specify the duties of each Position they are proposing to appoint members to.

(ii) In this circumstance, such Order(s) shall require the approval of a simple majority of Council, and may not be overruled as in Standing Order 8(1)(ii), or otherwise revoked save as in (vii) below.

(iii) The Junior President-Elect shall ensure to appoint:

(A) One member as Political Officer, to manage campaigning and policy.

(iv) Should any appointment not be ratified or should replacements be needed, the Junior President-Elect (who may by such time have succeeded to the office of Junior President) may bring further Order(s) at another date following the process in (i)-(ii) above.

(vi) The Junior President-Elect and Junior President shall at all times ensure that applications are open for these positions to the membership for at least 72 hours.

(vii) Council may, by two thirds majority, remove an Appointed Officer at any time, provided notice is given of such a motion to Council by the deadline for circulating the Agenda.

STANDING ORDER 2(3): HANDOVER

(i) All Position Holders are expected to meet with their successors before the transfer of power, and to produce a handover document. They should transfer all Association assets and documents in their possession.

(ii) Failure to do any of this in advance of power being transferred shall compel the Returning Officer to act in accordance with Rule 4(2)(e)(iv).

STANDING ORDER 2(4) PROHIBITED ORGANISATIONS

(i) No member who is a member, employee, or volunteer, of any of the following organisations shall be eligible to be a Junior Officer, Portfolio Officer, or Returning Officer:

(A) Any political party that runs candidates against the Liberal Democrats in Great Britain.

(ii) The prohibition in (i) took effect from the beginning of Hilary Term 2026. No person who has previously legitimately held a Position shall be denied the rights and seniority of an Ex-Holder of that Position due to this Rule.

(iii) The Senior President, or a two-thirds majority of Council present and voting (or simple majority if the party doesn't run candidates in England), may waive this prohibition for a specific person or person(s), in advance of the closing of nominations for their election, in advance of their appointment, or to allow them to complete their term. This shall only apply to a specific Position at a specific time. This shall be sent in writing to the Returning Officer and Junior President, with reasoning, and may not be revoked.

(iv) Any Position Holder and any Electoral Official who is a member of any of the organisations in (i) or any student press organisation shall be required to declare that membership to Council, in advance of their appointment or election - failure to do so shall be a disciplinary offence.

(v) Any Position Holder or Electoral Official who is a member of any of the organisations in (i) shall not be permitted to be present for *in camera* business of Council.

STANDING ORDER 2(6): COLLEGE REPRESENTATIVES

(a) General

(i) There shall be College Representatives (College Reps), whose duties shall be to attend and promote Association events. The Junior President-Elect shall be responsible for actively recruiting College Reps.

(ii) The Junior President or Junior President-Elect shall recommend appointments to Council, who shall ratify them by simple majority. A simple majority of Council may remove a College Rep at any time. Council may by simple majority provide discounted prices for events or other incentives for College Reps.

(iii) College Reps shall be Position Holders for the purposes of Rule 7.

(b) Group Chat

(i) The Junior President-Elect shall maintain an instant messaging chat with all College Reps, for the purposes of circulating information and imposing duties. Any Junior Officer so requesting shall be added to this chat.

STANDING ORDER 2(7): CHARITABLE ACTIVITY

(i) Should the Junior Treasurer not organise one session of charitable voluntary activity of not less than one hour before the Termly General Meeting, they shall be deemed to have resigned.

(ii) The Junior Treasurer shall, in conjunction with the Junior President, organise at least one event of the Association each term where the profits are donated to charity.

STANDING ORDER 2(8): WELFARE OFFICER

(i) The Junior President shall designate, via an Order-in-Council no later than Week 0, one Position Holder as Welfare Officer. The Welfare Officer shall ordinarily have relevant experience or training.

(ii) The Senior President may unilaterally exercise the power of a two-thirds majority of Council in Standing Order 8(1)(ii) to veto that appointment.

(iii) At each event, the Junior President shall ensure that there is at least one member available for sober welfare support, who shall ordinarily be the Welfare Officer.

STANDING ORDER 2(9): MISCELLANEOUS DUTIES

(a) Junior Secretary

(i) Maintaining the list of Ex-Officers, and Wikipedia page.

(b) Director of Communications

(i) Assisting with the creation and distribution of any paper material the Association produces.

PART 3: ELECTIONS

STANDING ORDER 3(1): TERMLY ELECTION REGULATIONS

(a) Eligibility

(i) Candidates are ineligible if they have held any elected office in either the Oxford Labour Club, Oxford University Conservative Association, Oxford Reform Society, or the Oxford Student Greens, within 10 calendar weeks (70 days) of the closing of nominations.

(ii) The Senior Officers and Electoral Officials are ineligible to stand for any Junior or Portfolio Office.

(iii) Candidates for Junior Officer must also meet the following requirements:

(A) Campaigning requirements:

(I) Should two campaigning sessions have been organised by the Association between the date of the last termly election and the opening of nominations, candidates must have completed at least one campaigning session of at least two hours since the last termly election.

(II) The candidate must submit evidence of campaigning to the Returning Officer before the closing of nominations.

(B) If standing for Junior President-Elect, they must be a student of the University of Oxford, and will be a student until they leave office, should they be successful. If standing for Junior Treasurer or Junior Secretary, they must be a student of the University of Oxford or Oxford Brookes University, and will be a student until they leave Office, if they be successful.

(C) They must be a member of the Liberal Democrats, or a member of a party in an international alliance which the Liberal Democrats or Young Liberals recognise as affiliated with themselves.

(iv) Two Senior Officers, acting together, may waive the requirements for any candidate in (i) or (iii) above, for a specific election, if they believe it to be in the interests of the Association. They shall do so in writing to the Returning Officer before the closing of nominations, providing reasons.

(v) Candidates for Women's Officer must identify as a woman.

(b) Manifestos

(i) Candidates for Junior Office shall be required to produce a manifesto of no more than 500 words. Candidates for Portfolio Office may submit a manifesto of no more than 300 words. Manifestos must be submitted with nomination forms. Failure of a Junior Office candidate to submit a manifesto shall render their nomination invalid.

(ii) Manifestos shall be submitted as simple black text on a white page. The Returning Officer shall be responsible for ensuring all manifestos in the official manifesto booklet are standardised to the same font, size and format. All information included on any other publicity, including online, must be included in the manifesto, or be a reasonable paraphrase as such. The Returning Officer may order the removal of any publicity that does not meet the conditions of this sub-clause.

(iii) In total, at least 50% of any candidate's manifesto shall detail any experience that demonstrates capability for the role that they are standing for. Where a candidate is a current or former Position Holder, at least 25% of their manifesto shall be dedicated to achievements within the Association. The Returning Officer shall ensure all manifestos meet word count and experience limits.

(iv) The Returning Officer shall provide all candidates and the Senior Officers with all manifestos no later than the end of Friday of 5th Week. Any member may request all manifestos after this time and shall be provided them within 24 hours.

(v) Any member may object in writing to the Returning Officer to any provision in a manifesto, on the grounds that it is false, misleading, unreasonable, unfeasible or otherwise a breach of the Governing Documents.

(vi) In response to an objection, or if they have a strong suspicion a claim breaches one of the conditions above, the Returning Officer may request that candidates produce evidence for any of their experience claims, or to determine the feasibility of their pledges. The burden shall be on candidates to fulfil this request at short notice.

(vii) The Returning Officer shall take representations from candidates on any objection, and on word count. All such representations shall ordinarily be taken together at a pre-arranged in person session. The Returning Officer shall determine whether or not to uphold any objection and alter manifestos as required. Final scrutinised manifestos shall be circulated to all candidates and Senior Officers no later than midday on Monday of 6th Week.

(viii) The Returning Officer shall publish an official manifesto booklet with all manifestos, once they have undergone all processes in this Standing Order. The Returning Officer shall circulate this via

email to the membership via email if convenient, and shall ensure that at least three copies are available to members at the point of casting their vote.

(c) Hustings

(i) Hustings shall take place for Junior Officer candidates during the first half an hour of the Liquor and Liberalism immediately preceding the termly election, should there be one. The Returning Officer or their delegate shall chair hustings.

(ii) Hustings speeches shall be no more than three minutes in length. Members shall have the opportunity to ask at least one question to candidates. Questions must be addressed to all candidates.

(iii) The Returning Officer may permit candidates for Portfolio Offices to hust, should time allow. Speeches may be shorter, at the discretion of the Returning Officer.

(iv) At the Returning Officer's discretion, an Electoral Official or another nominated member may give a short hustings speech in favour of None of the Above. They shall only speak once, representing None of the Above for all Positions.

(d) Social Media

(i) All posts made as a result of this clause must first be approved by the Returning Officer or their delegate. No post in regards to the election from Association accounts shall be produced or posted by a candidate, and shall only be produced or posted by the Returning Officer or their delegate. All posts shall be fair and balanced and not seek to advantage any specific candidate.

(ii) An Instagram post shall be released as soon as possible after the Opening of Nominations drawing attention to the nomination form and the deadline for nominations.

(iii) In the event of there being more than one validly nominated candidate for Junior President-Elect, an Instagram post shall be released at least 48 hours in advance of the election, introducing the candidates. This post shall also include the date and time of the election.

(iv) The Returning Officer, at their discretion, may request the production of other posts in relation to the election, including 'Meet the Candidates' posts for other positions.

(e) Poll

(i) Should a Poll be required, it shall be held between Wednesday of 6th Week and Sunday of 7th Week, inclusive. Council shall, at a meeting in 4th or 5th Week, determine the date of the Poll, in case one should be required.

(ii) The Poll shall be open for at least three hours. The Returning Officer and Senior Treasurer may agree to extend this to up to six hours. The Poll shall begin after 14.00.

(iii) The Returning Officer shall be responsible for securing a venue for the Poll. The Junior President and Senior Treasurer shall assist in this. The venue shall normally be a Pub in central Oxford.

(f) Termly elections at General Meetings

(i) Where the termly elections are to be held at a General Meeting, the Returning Officer shall conduct the election when scheduled on the Agenda, and store the ballot box in plain view until the conclusion of the meeting. The Count shall occur immediately after the conclusion of the meeting.

(g) Counting regulations

(i) Any members of the Senior Committee, and Junior Officers who are not candidates, shall have the right to observe the Count. No person other than the Electoral Officials, Observers and Count Representatives shall be permitted to be present for the Count – unless with the consent of the Returning Officer.

(ii) Each candidate may provide a Count Representative. Count Representatives may represent members across different Positions. Electoral Officials may not be Count Representatives, and any member of the Emeritus Committee who serves as a Count Representative shall be deemed conflicted for the purposes of any Emeritus Committee business relating to that election.

(iii) The Returning Officer shall accept a ballot that they reasonably believe demonstrates a clear positive indication of first preference, even if it does not use Arabic numerals. The Returning Officer shall only accept further preferences where they reasonably believe an Arabic numerical preference is clear.

(iv) Count Representatives shall have the duty to ensure a true result is returned, to aid in this duty they shall have the power to object to the Returning Officer's or another Electoral Official's interpretation of a ballot. The Returning Officer shall retain final interpretative power over ballots cast, although a Count Representative may ask objected ballots to be signed for the purposes of disciplinary proceedings regarding an election result.

(v) If any candidate meets the quota of 50% of valid votes cast on first preferences alone, they shall automatically be elected. If no candidate meets the quota on first preferences, the candidate with the least amount of first preferences shall be eliminated, and their preferences redistributed. This process shall continue, with redistribution of preferences, until a candidate has met the required quota or there be no other candidates remaining, and the winner shall be declared duly elected.

(vi) Results shall be announced in person at the conclusion of the Count, and the time at which this is completed shall be recorded. Results shall be uploaded to the website within one week of this time; any member requesting the results in written form before this shall be provided them as soon as possible by the Returning Officer.

(h) Ties

(i) Where two candidates are tied in any round of counting, ties shall first be broken by virtue of the Table of Seniority, with the candidate with the lower seniority being eliminated. None of the Above shall always be considered to have lower seniority than any member candidate.

(ii) Should there be no difference in seniority, for example where both candidates are Ordinary Members, those voting members of Council able to attend within 10 minutes of being given notice via instant messaging by the Returning Officer, shall be instructed to vote between the two candidates. The loser of this vote shall be eliminated. Should this vote also be a tie, the individual who would have been the Chair, had the tie-break vote been an Ordinary Meeting of Council, shall have a casting vote.

(i) Destruction of electoral materials

(i) Once there is no further prospect under the Governing Documents of proceedings regarding a termly election continuing, the Returning Officer shall, in the presence of at least one Senior Officer, destroy all materials relating to that election. This shall include, but not be limited to, ballot papers and registers.

(j) Miscellaneous

(i) Proxy votes shall only be granted where an election is being held via a Poll and all of the following conditions are met:

(A) The member contacts the Returning Officer by email at least 12 hours before the opening of Poll, and in that email states their reason for requesting a proxy, names their proxy and notes their ordinary residence location.

(B) The Returning Officer reasonably believes that the member is prevented from voting because of a protected characteristic as defined under the Equality Act 2010.

(C) The member is ordinarily resident within 25 miles of Carfax Tower. 'Ordinarily resident' shall not include students on years abroad, or who have suspended their studies and do not live in Oxford.

(ii) The Returning Officer and Senior Treasurer shall agree an itemised election budget, which shall ordinarily not exceed £50. The Returning Officer may direct any debit card holder to conduct electoral expenditure, with reasonable notice.

(iii) 'None of the Above' shall be considered a candidate for the purposes of the Count and any list of candidates.

(iv) Electoral Officials shall use red ink in the course of the termly election. Any ballot containing red ink anywhere other than as would have been strictly necessary for Electoral Officials to perform their function (e.g. the signature or ballot number) shall be void. The Returning Officer shall advertise to members not to use red.

STANDING ORDER 3(2): ELECTION OF THE SENIOR COMMITTEE

(i) The elections to Senior Committee shall be conducted in accordance with the provisions of the Standard Constitution. They shall be by the method of paper ballot Alternative Vote, where None of the Above shall not be an option. An Electoral Official shall administer the election at the Annual General Meeting.

(ii) The members of the Senior Committee shall approve their nominations for the following year's Committee by the end of 3rd Week of Hilary Term. These nominations shall be sent in writing to the Junior President and Returning Officer. The Senior Secretary shall ensure that those nominations are included in the notice of the Annual General Meeting, along with an explanation of how other members can nominate themselves. The Senior Committee shall be empowered to nominate any member, including those who have not expressed interest.

(iii) Members not nominated by the Senior Committee may nominate by emailing the Returning Officer and Senior Secretary at least seven days prior to the Annual General Meeting or by the deadline for nominations to the termly election, whichever is earliest. Such nominations also require a seconder, who must be copied into the email. The Returning Officer and Senior Secretary shall ensure that a full list of candidates is included in the Agenda.

(iv) Senior Committee elections shall always be on a separate ballot paper to any other elections. In the circumstance that the Returning Officer wishes to stand for Senior Office, the Senior Committee elections should be managed by the most senior Electoral Official who is not a candidate. They shall be deemed to be the Acting Returning Officer, for the purposes of the Senior Committee elections alone.

(v) The Senior Committee shall take office from the Trinity Term following the Hilary General Meeting in which they are elected until the conclusion of the following Hilary. They shall be deemed to have resigned from any other Association Positions they may hold upon their ascension to a Senior Office.

(vi) Elections to the Senior Committee shall be subject to the electoral malpractice rules and procedures set out in Rules 5 and 7.

(vii) The Committee may delay nomination of a candidate for a Senior Office if the member they wish to nominate is seeking election as a Sabbatical Officer in the Oxford Student Union. The Senior Committee must ensure that their nomination for that Office is delivered in time for the publication of the final list of candidates.

(viii) In the event that there is only one nominated candidate for a Senior Committee position, that member shall be deemed to be elected at the point of the closing of nominations. They shall no longer be considered a candidate for the purposes of any other Rules and Standing Orders, save for Complaints or Appeals relation to the election, as appropriate.

STANDING ORDER 3(3): SELECTION OF THE RETURNING OFFICER

(i) The Returning Officer shall be deemed to have resigned at the beginning of Week 0. Should the Returning Officer's resignation or removal take effect between 8th Week and Week -2 inclusive, the Vice Returning Officer shall serve as Acting Returning Officer until a replacement is appointed in Week -1 or later.

(ii) The Senior President shall open applications by writing to the membership within 48 hours of need arising for a new Returning Officer. There shall also be a post on Instagram. They shall invite from the membership written statements, with a stated deadline, not exceeding 350 words, detailing experience and capability for the role, as well as desire for taking it up.

(iii) The Senior President shall share applications with the Returning Officer, who shall recommend to the Senior President a member to appoint.

(iv) The Senior President shall nominate a member via an Order-in-Council. Standing Order 8(1)(ii) shall not apply to that Order. The Order shall only take effect upon ratification by Council.

(v) Should the Senior President be proposing a Deputy Returning Officer who was recommended by the Returning Officer, ratification shall be by a simple majority of Council. Should the Senior President's nominee not be a Deputy Returning Officer, or not be the member recommended by the Returning Officer, ratification shall require a two-thirds majority.

(vi) Should Council reject the nomination, the Senior President shall propose a new member, who need not have been one of the original applicants.

(vii) The newly elected Returning Officer shall take office immediately upon their predecessor actually vacating office. Should the office be vacant, they shall assume it immediately.

STANDING ORDER 3(4): SELECTION OF ELECTORAL OFFICIALS

(a) Deputy Returning Officers

(i) Deputy Returning Officers shall only cease to hold office when they are replaced, they resign or are removed. Deputy Returning Officers shall have the status of Position Holders for the purposes Rule 7 and seniority only.

(ii) The Returning Officer shall open nominations for Deputy Returning Officer in Week 0, allowing at least 72 hours for all members to apply. The Returning Officer shall, in addition to sharing the opening of nominations with the wider membership, contact the current Deputy Returning Officers and all Ex-Returning Officers *in statu pupillari* directly advising them when nominations are open.

(iii) At Council in 1st Week, the Returning Officer shall present the full list of applicants for Deputy Returning Officer who met the deadline. The list should be ordered by experience at the discretion of the Returning Officer, save that Ex-Returning Officers shall take precedence over other members.

(iv) Council may, by two-thirds majority, strike a name from the list. Council may, by two-thirds majority, re-order names on the list save Ex-Returning Officers. Then, any Ex-Returning Officers and the four highest remaining names who are not Ex-Returning Officers, shall become Deputy Returning Officers.

(v) The Junior President shall, via an Order-in-Council, appoint a Deputy Returning Officer to serve as Vice Returning Officer. They shall serve until a successor is appointed in the same manner.

(vi) Should there at any time be fewer than four Deputy Returning Officers who are not Ex-Returning Officers, or the Returning Officer wishes to add another Ex-Returning Officer, the Returning Officer may augment the list by presenting a new name(s) to either be struck or not struck at any meeting of Council.

(vii) Any member who ceases to be Returning Officer shall be added as a Deputy Returning Officer automatically until the passage of the next list, unless they state in writing they do not wish to be, or it is ordered otherwise by the Emeritus Committee.

(viii) Anyone who is an Electoral Official at the time of or after the Opening of Nominations in any termly election or by-election shall not be eligible to nominate as a candidate in that election.

(ix) Council may, by two thirds majority remove any Deputy Returning Officer, or by three-quarters majority remove the Returning Officer, provided 12 hours notice of such a motion is given.

(b) Returning Officer's Assistants

(i) The Returning Officer shall be empowered in full term to appoint as many consenting Returning Officer's Assistants as they so require, via email to the Junior President and Senior Treasurer, who shall serve from their appointment until 12 hours after the announcement of the results in the termly election. They shall have the status of Position Holders for the purposes of Rule 7 only.

(ii) The Senior Treasurer, Returning Officer, or a simple majority of Council, may remove any Returning Officer's Assistant at any time.

STANDING ORDER 3(5): SENIORITY AMONG ELECTORAL OFFICIALS

(i) The seniority among Electoral Officials shall be as follows:

The Returning Officer,
The Vice Returning Officer,
Other Deputy Returning Officers *in order of the shortlist.*
Returning Officer's Assistants *with the person appointed longest ago first and so on,*

(ii) Where necessary, for the purposes of an Acting Returning Officer or Clerk, the following shall also have seniority below that of Returning Officer's Assistants, in order of recency of leaving Office where there is more than one Ex-Holder of the same Office:

Ex-Returning Officers who are not Deputy Returning Officers, *in statu pupillari or were in the last twelve months,*
Ex-Deputy Returning Officers *in statu pupillari,*
Ex-Presidents *in statu pupillari,*
Any member *in statu pupillari* appointed by the Senior President or Senior Member.

STANDING ORDER 3(6): EXPANSION ON RULE 5(2)(a)(iii)

(a) At a minimum, the Senior Treasurer shall:

(i) Attend the Count as an observer,
(ii) Provide neutral advice to candidates when so requested.

PART 4: EVENTS

STANDING ORDER 4(1): ACCESSIBLE ROOMS

(i) It shall be a reasonable duty on the Junior President to ensure that events of the Association are hosted in spaces that are fully accessible to those with disabilities.

(ii) There shall be a reasonable duty on the Junior President to ensure that events run in conjunction with other societies and other organisations, shall be hosted in spaces that are fully accessible to those with disabilities.

STANDING ORDER 4(2): LIQUOR AND LIBERALISM

(i) There shall be an event called Liquor and Liberalism, where members and non-members may engage in debate, and drinks shall be served. The Junior President shall organise at least four events of this nature each term.

(ii) Members shall at all times behave themselves with decency and decorum, and shall not abuse or sexualise any other person at any time.

(iii) At the beginning of each event, the Junior President, the nominated sober officer, or a deputy, shall give a brief notice to the membership reminding them of expected behaviour and the available sober welfare support.

(iv) The Junior President shall nominate one member, ordinarily another Position Holder, to serve as Assistant Treasurer at each event, who shall assist the Junior Treasurer in taking payments at the door.

STANDING ORDER 4(3): FREE ENTRY TO EVENTS

(i) Honorary Officers and the Senior Member shall be entitled to free attendance including all costs, at any event of the Association.

(ii) Ex-Presidents and Ex-Vice Presidents, who are not Honorary Officers or the Senior Member, shall be entitled to free attendance including all costs, at any event of the Association up to a total of £15 per event.

STANDING ORDER 4(4): REMOVAL FROM EVENTS

(i) The Junior President, or in their absence the most senior Position Holder present, or the agent of either, shall have the absolute authority to remove any person from an event who they feel is acting in breach of the Governing Documents or is an active impediment to its smooth functioning. Position Holders or their agents shall not be protected from disciplinary action for doing so.

PART 5: DISCIPLINARY

STANDING ORDER 5(1): FURTHER EMERITUS COMMITTEE PROCEDURE

(a) Delegate of the Emeritus Committee

(i) Where a Delegate of the Emeritus Committee is to be appointed, they shall be the consenting member of the Emeritus Committee, not otherwise barred, highest on the following list:

(A) Ex-Returning Officers, with the member elected longest ago first and so on,
(B) A law graduate, or law student not in their first year,
(C) The member who has served the longest on the Emeritus Committee, with ties being broken by the Table of Seniority.

(ii) Unless otherwise specified, ties in one category shall be broken by cumulative length of service on the Emeritus Committee in terms, not days. Inclusion on a term's Emeritus Committee shortlist, or being added to the list later in term, shall be deemed to be one term's service.

(b) Naming of Rulings and Cases

(i) The Emeritus Committee, or the Returning Officer with the consent of the Senior President, shall be empowered to amend the names of Rulings and cases so as to ensure compliance with this Standing Order.

(ii) For an ordinary Disciplinary Complaint brought by one member against another member, the case should simply be known as Member v Member, for example:

Lloyd-George v Gladstone

(iii) For an Disciplinary Complaint brought by the Returning Officer as part of their duties, or brought by the Junior President or Junior President-Elect on the basis of a Referral, the case should be known as Position Holder (Name) v Member:

Returning Officer (Mill) v Lloyd-George
Junior President (Asquith) v Lloyd-George

(iv) For an Appeal brought under the element of the Rules that allows challenges to decisions of Position Holders, for Appeals to Rulings of the Returning Officer, or cases under Rule 5(i)(i)(I) against the Returning Officer, the case should be known as Member v the Body/Position Holder (name) whose action/decision is being appealed. Should the Appellant be a Body it shall be Body v Body/Position Holder (name).

Lloyd-George v Senior Officers
Lloyd-George v Returning Officer (Mill)

(v) For a Complaint brought corporately by any Body in accordance with the Standing Orders, the case shall be known as Body v Member:

Senior Officers v Lloyd-George

(vi) Cases shall be referenced with the name of the case, the term in square brackets, the Body reference, and then the number of the Session of the Emeritus Committee in which the case was heard. It should also be added whether a case is cited in *in camera* form (IC) or public form (P). Body references shall be RO (Returning Officer), DEC (Delegate of the Emeritus Committee) EC (Emeritus Committee) and AC (Appeals Committee). Rulings of the Returning Officer should be given a succinct name that summarises the matter at hand, or named after the member requesting the Ruling (with their consent), and prefaced with *In re*. For example:

In re: Lloyd George [TT99] RO
Lloyd-George v Returning Officer (Mill) [TT99] EC-21-P
Lloyd-George (Appellant) v Returning Officer (Mill)[TT29] AC-P

STANDING ORDER 5(2): PAST SOCIETY PENALTIES

(i) When any member becomes aware of evidence that a penalty imposed by a Disciplinary Body of the Oxford University Liberal Democrats, or another previous iteration of the Association, would still be in effect, and thus has, or may have, impact on the Association, they shall refer this matter to the Returning Officer in writing.

(ii) The Returning Officer shall review the evidence available to them, and make a first instance determination as to whether they believe:

(A) That the Body that imposed the (purported) penalty constitutes a valid Disciplinary Body,
(B) That the (purported) penalty was imposed,
(C) That the (purported) penalty is still in effect and thus has, or may have, impact on the Association.

(iii) The Returning Officer shall inform the referring member and the member who had the penalty imposed against them ('the Subject') of the outcome of their determination, and any effect it has on their interaction with the Association.

(iv) The Subject and the referring member shall then be entitled to Appeal this decision under the usual procedure in Rule 1(c), and shall be advised of this fact by the Returning Officer. An incorrect determination by the Returning Officer under (ii) above shall be deemed to have misapplied and misinterpreted the Governing Documents. The Subject, referring member, and Returning Officer shall be entitled to be Respondents to this Appeal.

(v) The entirety of proceedings under this Standing Order shall be *in camera*, unless the Emeritus Committee unanimously determines otherwise.

(vi) The proceedings under this Standing Order shall only exist to make findings of fact in relation to (purported) previous disciplinary processes. The Emeritus Committee shall not function as an Appellate Body to the original penalty, nor hear any detail of the case beyond what is necessary to ascertain such a fact.

STANDING ORDER 5(3): COMPLAINTS IN THE MEMBERS' INTERESTS

(i) Any member may refer in writing to either the Junior President or Junior President-Elect, information regarding behaviour that may form the basis of a Complaint. The Junior President(-Elect) shall inform the Returning Officer, or if they are conflicted, the Vice Returning Officer, if they receive any such Referral.

(ii) The Junior President(-Elect) shall be reasonably empowered to make further inquiries into the matter, in consultation with the (Vice) Returning Officer. It shall be a disciplinary offence to deliberately frustrate such inquiries.

(iii) Should the Junior President(-Elect) believe that the Complaint has a realistic prospect of success, is not frivolous, vexatious or malicious, and that its pursuit is in the interests of the Association, they shall bring a Complaint to the Emeritus Committee in accordance with Rule 7 and inform the referring member. Should they decline the Referral, the Junior President(-Elect) shall give their reasons in writing to the referring member.

(iv) A decision on whether to bring a Complaint or not shall be made within seven calendar days of the initial Referral. Should the Referral be declined, the member is not precluded from making a Complaint under Rule 7 in a personal capacity. Where a member chooses to do this, the Emeritus Committee shall also review the decision of the Junior President(-Elect) to decline the Referral.

(v) All Position Holders shall be required to act impartially, in the interests of the Association, and in order to prevent breaches of the Governing Documents, in the actioning of their duties under this Standing Order.

(vi) The Junior President(-Elect) shall be empowered to appoint a Representative to assist them in fulfilling their functions under this Standing Order.

STANDING ORDER 5(4): ADDITIONS TO THE EMERITUS COMMITTEE SHORTLIST

(i) The Returning Officer may invite individuals to consent who do not fulfil the *ex officio* criteria in Rule 7(b)(ii), with the consent of at least two Senior Officers, if they are of the reasonable belief that the final shortlist will not be sufficient in number.

(ii) Should the Returning Officer deem it necessary after the Senior Member exercises their striking power, they may present new names to the Senior Member at any time, with the consent of at least two Senior Officers.

(iii) Best efforts shall be made to ensure that each Session of the Emeritus Committee contains at least one member entitled to sit *ex officio.*

PART 6: MEETINGS AND COMMITTEES

STANDING ORDER 6(1): FURTHER MEETING PROCEDURE

(a) General

(i) Should the relevant President not be present, or be unwilling to Chair - then the next most senior consenting person on the Table of Seniority who is not the Senior Member, who is a member of the relevant body, shall take the Chair. For the purposes of this clause, Ex-Presidents *in statu pupillari* shall rank after the Junior President-Elect.

(ii) Should the relevant Secretary not be present, or be unwilling to minute, the Chair shall appoint a member to serve as secretary to that meeting.

(iii) Where 'consent', 'approval' or other such methods are required by these Governing Documents, granting or refusal must be noted by the person so requesting at the next minuted meeting of the most appropriate body. This shall be Council, unless there is a good reason for it to be another body.

(iv) Where a Position Holder sends apologies to the Junior Secretary stating a reason for absence at least 30 minutes before the scheduled start of a meeting, the Junior Secretary or their delegate shall be obligated to move a motion to pass their absence stating the reasons given.

(v) A person shall be deemed absent from a meeting if they are not present for at least two-thirds of its duration. Any Junior Officer not present at the location of a meeting within ten minutes of its scheduled start time shall also be deemed to have been absent.

(b) Council

(i) For Ordinary Meetings, Agenda items shall be submitted to the Junior Secretary at least 24 hours before the time of the meeting. The Junior Secretary shall circulate the agenda to all members of Council at least 12 hours before the start of the meeting. The minutes of the previous Ordinary Meeting and any Extraordinary Meetings that have taken place since the last Ordinary Meeting, should also be circulated with the Agenda.

(ii) For Council, no matter not specified on the Agenda, save any matter legitimately arising under 'Business Arising from the Minutes', shall be voted on or any substantive decision taken if two Members of Council, being present at the time the matter arises, object before any motion is moved on that matter. This shall not apply to business that the Rules or Standing Orders reserve for any specific meeting.

(iii) Council shall be able to conduct urgent votes as necessary via a method of instant messaging. Such a vote must be open for at least two hours, and permission shall first be sought from a Senior Officer, unless the person moving the vote is a Senior Officer. Any such vote shall require a two-thirds majority of those voting to carry, and a quorum of at least half of voting members to have cast their vote. The details of any such vote shall be recorded by the mover at the next Ordinary Meeting of Council.

(c) Termly General Meetings

(i) The minutes of General Meetings shall be proposed for ratification by the Senior Secretary at the next General Meeting or at a meeting of Council, where all members present shall be allowed to vote.

(ii) The Senior President shall decide the requirements for the length of Position Holders' Reports to the Termly General Meeting, including any requirements to submit the Report, or a summary, in advance of the Meeting. They shall ensure that Position Holders are given due notice of these requirements.

(iii) No matter not on the Agenda may be voted on, nor any substantive decision taken, save with the unanimous consent of all Senior and Junior Officers present.

(d) Policy Motions

(i) The Junior President-Elect and Political Officer shall be required to submit one Policy Motion to the 3rd Week General Meeting. Where there are more than four total motions, the Senior President shall, having taken advice from the Political Officer, select four motions to be debated. All Policy Motions that are to be debated shall be included on the Agenda.

(ii) Policies may be repealed by a Motion at a subsequent General Meeting. Should a new proposal that is passed be substantially different from a previously passed proposal, at the determination of the Political Officer, then implied repeal shall be deemed to have taken place. All policies shall automatically expire at the end of Saturday of 8th Week of the 5th full term after their passage, unless otherwise specified or renewed by a new motion.

(iii) Members may submit amendments to any Policy Motion. Amendments are to be incorporated into a Motion by simple majority vote.

(iv) The Political Officer shall be responsible for creating a digital policy book listing all extant policies with the addition of any adopted at the meeting. This shall be freely available to all members.

(e) Minutes

(i) No minutes shall be ratified that do not meet the following criteria in relation to the relevant meeting:

(A) A list of those who registered attendance, including full names and positions,
(B) The date and time of opening, and the time of closing,
(C) Provide an accurate summary of the discussions had and key contributions,
(D) Record the passage or rejection of any motions, including movers, seconders and objectors,
(E) Record which business is *in camera* and *ex camera*, and ensure *in camera* business is not shared in public minutes.

(ii) Minutes that are yet to be ratified shall be watermarked as 'Draft' minutes when circulated for consideration. Upon ratification, the secretary shall note the meeting at which the minutes were ratified on the draft minutes, remove the watermark and circulate the final, ratified minutes.

(iii) All meetings shall be audio recorded by the secretary to that meeting, and these recordings shall be uploaded onto a shared drive within one hour of the conclusion of the meeting. This drive shall be accessible by, at a minimum, the Senior and Junior Secretary, the Senior and Junior President, and the Returning Officer.

(iv) Three failures by any one individual to produce quality minutes in any one term shall result in their automatic resignation as Junior Secretary, Senior Secretary or any other Position which affords a member duties under this Standing Order. The Returning Officer shall be responsible for determining, via a Ruling, when three failures have occurred.

(v) *Ex camera* minutes shall be publicly available to all members, and further available on request within 24 hours to the Junior Secretary. *In camera* minutes shall be maintained in an online drive by

the Junior Secretary, and available on request within 24 hours to any member of Council or the Senior Member.

STANDING ORDER 6(2): SENIOR COMMITTEE AUDIT

(i) The Senior Committee shall be summoned at least once a term. One of their meetings shall be designated as the Audit meeting; the Senior Member shall not be obliged to attend, and may offer participation in writing. The Audit meeting shall take place before the Termly General Meeting, and ideally in 5th Week.

(ii) The Senior President shall write to all those listed in (iii) below to inform them of the Audit meeting, and their deadlines for submission.

(iii) The following shall be required to submit documents and information as listed in advance of the Audit meeting, within 48 hours of being informed:

> (A) The Junior President shall be required to submit a report of their work in the term so far, and a summary of the work of the Portfolio Officers and Appointed Position Holders. The Committee may ask for specifics within that summary.
>
> (B) The Junior President-Elect shall be required to update the Committee on the progression of preparations for the next term.
>
> (C) The Junior Treasurer shall be required to submit the full financials of the Association, with explanations for any losses.
>
> (D) Any person who has served as Junior Secretary since the last Audit meeting shall be required to submit any and all minutes for review.
>
> (E) The Returning Officer shall be required to submit to the Committee a summary of any Emeritus Committee cases since the last Audit meeting, including their findings.

(iv) The Committee shall review all the information provided to them, with a view to ensuring the good and efficient governance of the Association.

(v) The Committee shall produce a Report, ordinarily authored by the Senior President. This Report shall contain its opinions of the current state of governance of the Association, and any recommendations it has for improvements.

(vi) The Senior Officers shall be empowered by simple majority vote, to bring a disciplinary complaint or complaints, or to instruct the Returning Officer to bring a disciplinary complaint or complaints,

where they feel a dereliction of duty has occurred. The Senior Member shall ordinarily not participate in discussion of such a matter.

(vii) Failure to comply with the provisions of this Standing Order shall be a disciplinary offence.

STANDING ORDER 6(3): SUB-COMMITTEES

(i) The Junior President via an Order-in-Council, or a simple majority of Council, may constitute such sub-committees as may be necessary from time to time.

(ii) Where the proposing member so requests, and gives sufficient notice (ordinarily at least ten days), the Junior President shall be responsible for constituting an Amendment Scrutiny Committee of at least three members to scrutinise the contents of any proposed Amendment to the Rules and Standing Orders.

PART 7: MEMBERSHIP

STANDING ORDER 7(1): MEMBERSHIP ADMINISTRATION

(a) General

(i) The Senior Secretary shall be responsible for overseeing the membership register. The Returning Officer may delegate their responsibilities under this Standing Order to another consenting Electoral Official.

(ii) The Returning Officer shall ensure that new members are added once they are validly admitted to membership, and shall ensure to remove graduated members and store their details separately. All new members shall be announced at the next Ordinary Meeting of Council.

(iii) Any membership form, digital or physical, should collect a prospective member's name, institution (ordinarily college), email address, matriculation and expected graduation terms, and record consent to be bound by the Governing Documents.

(iv) In circumstances where an individual does not appear on the register of members, but the Returning Officer has reason to believe that they should, they may amend the register. They shall inform the Senior Secretary of this action within 24 hours and announce it at the next Meeting of Council. The Senior Secretary may do the same at any time, and may reasonably choose to reverse the Returning Officer's decision up to seven days after it is made.

(v) Where the Returning Officer exercises their power under (iii) for electoral purposes, a record shall be kept. The Returning Officer shall note at the announcement of the results that they have exercised this power, and shall provide, to any candidate who requests within one hour of the announcement of results, the full list within four hours of the announcement.

(vi) The Senior Secretary's reversal power in (iii) above shall not exist when the Returning Officer exercises this power between the closing of nominations and the announcement of the results in the termly election.

(b) Resignation of membership

(i) Members may resign their membership in writing to the Returning Officer, who shall inform the next meeting of Council.

(ii) No person who resigns their membership shall be readmitted save with the approval of two Senior Officers

(c) Determination of the membership fee in accordance with Rule 3(a)

(i) Following consultation with Position Holders, the Junior Treasurer shall issue an Order-in-Council no later than the end of Week 1 determining the membership fee for that term. The price set may only be discounted by up to 50% during that term.

STANDING ORDER 7(2): HONORARY MEMBERS

(i) Council, or a General Meeting, may by two-thirds majority vote confer (or subsequently remove) Honorary Membership on any person it so chooses, regardless of their status or eligibility under (a) above. Honorary Membership shall last for one year.

(ii) Honorary Members, both lifetime and annual, do not need to be included on mailing lists and other mechanisms of notice, unless they so request to the Junior Secretary.

(iii) Each Senior and Junior President may appoint one person to lifetime honorary membership of the Association, regardless of that person's status or eligibility under (a) above, which shall not require ratification. Such a person can only be removed by the Emeritus Committee.

PART 8: MISCELLANEOUS

STANDING ORDER 8(1): ORDERS-IN-COUNCIL

(ii) A two-thirds majority of Council may overturn an Order-in-Council. If this is done at the meeting in which an Order is made, it shall be deemed to have always been void.

(iii) Any Order-in-Council must be sent to the Returning Officer within 24 hours of the conclusion of the meeting in which it is announced.

(iv) Outside of full term, or in full term with the consent of the Senior President, Orders-in-Council may be made outwith a meeting of Council, and instead via email to all members of Council.

STANDING ORDER 8(2): MINOR EDITS TO THE GOVERNING DOCUMENTS

(i) The Returning Officer may make minor edits to the Rules, Standing Orders, and Interpretations only so as to correct issues with spelling, grammar, clause demarcation, cross-references and other such linguistic matters, or to clarify disputes over whether parts of the Governing Document refer to specific Senior or Junior Officers.

(ii) These edits shall not affect the intention, effect, or procedure of the section of the Rules, Standing Orders or Interpretations in question.

(iii) Any such edits shall be explained at the next meeting of Council by the Returning Officer or their agent. A minor edit shall automatically be reversed if this is not done.

(iv) If any member believes an edit to be incompatible with, or in breach of, the provisions of (i)-(iii) above, then they may appeal it directly within seven days to the Emeritus Committee. If an edit is appealed, it shall be suspended in its entirety until the Emeritus Committee concludes on that matter.

STANDING ORDER 8(3): ENDORSEMENTS AND PATRONAGE

(a) General

(i) The Association may vote to endorse another organisation or to donate funds to another organisation or person. This can only be approved by a simple majority vote of the Council.

(ii) The Association supports the Liberal Democrats and no other political party in Great Britain.

(iii) The Association may issue official statements, statements of policy and other such comments on political matters as may be necessary from time to time. Such statements or comments must be approved by a simple majority of Council. Such statements or comments shall not be deemed to represent the individual views of those voting for or against, or of the membership more widely.

(iv) The Association may, by a simple majority of Council, endorse candidates in external elections, so long as this does not contravene the Rules of that election. This shall not prevent members of the Association from supporting other candidates.

(b) Affiliated Organisations

(i) In addition to endorsing organisations as under (a)(i) above, the Association may also have specific arrangements with party and external organisations. These are at present:

(A) Liberals for CANZUK, including any future names it may adopt.

(ii) Any member of the Association who is also a member of the Liberal Democrats, or a member of a party in an international alliance which the Liberal Democrats or Young Liberals recognise as affiliated with themselves, shall automatically be considered to be a member of Liberals for CANZUK, provided the following conditions are met:

(A) This is clearly stated on the Association membership form, or otherwise explicitly communicated.
(B) There is an option to opt-out provided.

STANDING ORDER 8(4): RETURNING OFFICER'S ARCHIVE

(i) The Returning Officer shall be responsible for maintaining an archive of matters related to their work, which shall be stored on the official Returning Officer gmail account.

(ii) This shall contain at a minimum, from the re-founding:

(A) Election Results,
(B) Emeritus Committee Reports and Minutes,
(C) All editions of the Governing Documents and their predecessors,
(D) The History of Amendments Folder,
(E) All minutes of Council, or other equivalent bodies.

(iii) Members may request to see parts of the archive. The Returning Officer shall make a copy of only the relevant parts to send to such a member. The Returning Officer shall take care not to share any *in camera* material, unless otherwise authorised.

(iv) Making unsanctioned copies of the archive shall be considered a Disciplinary Offence.

STANDING ORDER 8(5): PRESIDENT'S AWARD

(i) Each Junior President may bestow, via an Order-in-Council, on members:

(A) One: President's Award - First Class,
(B) Two: President's Award - Second Class.

(ii) Such an award shall be in recognition of extraordinary meritorious service to the Association. A member may receive a subsequent award higher in class than one they have previously received.

(iii) Once bestowed, any Award may only be revoked by the Emeritus Committee, at their discretion. President's Awards shall not be subject to Standing Order 8(1)(ii).

(iv) All members holding the seniority of Ex-President *in statu pupillari* shall be entitled to bestow, via an Order-in-Council, the President's Award in accordance with (i)-(ii) above before the end of Trinity Term 2026. They shall be informed in writing of this right by the Junior President as soon as possible. This sub-clause shall automatically repeal at the end of Trinity Term 2026.

(v) Recipients of the President's Award shall be entitled to half-price entry at Liquor and Liberalism.

SECTION 5: INTERPRETATIONS

INTERPRETATIONS OF THE APPEALS COMMITTEE

None

INTERPRETATIONS OF THE EMERITUS COMMITTEE

Emeritus Committee Interpretation 1: Validation of Party Membership

With regards to Standing Order 3(1)(a)(iii)(C): Where a prospective electoral candidate must prove that they are a member of the Liberal Democrats or appropriate international sister party, the Returning Officer must be satisfied that the evidence provided to them is legitimate, and is evidence for the membership of the prospective candidate themselves, as proven by the presence of their name, or their membership number and additional proof that that number is the prospective candidate's own membership number. They must also be satisfied that the membership is in date.

Issued 19th June 2025, *Morgan v Returning Officer (Farhan) EC-4-P*
Amended by Aaron Zeleke, *University* - 14/07/2026

INTERPRETATIONS OF THE RETURNING OFFICER

Returning Officer's Interpretation 1: Junior Office Requirements

Any individual appointed to Junior Office outside of the normal election procedures, must meet the eligibility requirements set out by the Governing Documents for that Junior Office, unless explicitly stated otherwise. Thus, individuals appointed to Junior Office by Council must be a student of the University of Oxford, and will be a student until they leave office, as proven by a valid dated student Bodleian Card. Moreover, these individuals appointed must be a member of the Liberal Democrats, or a recognised international sister party, as must be evidenced through proof of current membership of such an organisation, such as an email confirmation when one signed up to the party.

Harriet Dolby, *Lady Margaret Hall*- 10/07/25
Amended by Aaron Zeleke, *University* - 14/07/2026

Returning Officer's Interpretation 2: Campaigning Requirements for Junior Office under Standing Order 3(1)(iii)(A)(1)

The campaigning requirements under Standing Order 3(1)(iii)(A)(1) may be met by campaigning for the Liberal Democrats or any party in an international alliance which the Liberal Democrats recognise as affiliated with themselves.

Thomas Crossley, *Christ Church* - 18/02/26
Amended by Aaron Zeleke, *University* - 14/07/2026

Returning Officer's Interpretation 3: Proof of ISP status for voters in Senior Officer Elections

In order to vote in a Senior Officer Election a voter must be able to prove that they are *in statu pupillari* with either a current, valid and physical University Card or adequate written evidence of being a suspended member of the University such as an official college letter.

Thomas Crossley, *Christ Church* - 24/02/26

SECTION 6: SCHEDULES

SCHEDULES

SCHEDULE 1: SCHEDULE OF HONORARY OFFICERS

1. Honorary Chair: Rt Hon Lord Newby OBE (*St Catherine's*)
Trinity Term 2026 until the end of Michaelmas Term 2027

2. Founding President *or* President Emeritus: Zagham Farhan (Ex-President, *University*)
Trinity Term 2026 until Trinity Term 2031